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NOTE FROM THE SECRETARY GENERAL REQUESTING THE INCLUSION
OF A PRESENTATION OF THE THIRTY-EIGHTH SEMIANNUAL REPORT OF
THE MISSION TO SUPPORT THE PEACE PROCESS IN COLOMBIA (MAPP/OAS)
ON THE ORDER OF BUSINESS FOR THE PERMANENT COUNCIL'S
REGULAR MEETING, SCHEDULED FOR JUNE 18, 2025



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His Excellency Benoni Belli
Ambassador, Permanent Mission of Brazil
and Chair of Permanent Council
Organization of American States
Washington, D.C.

Excellency:

I have the honor to address Your Excellency to request, through your good offices, that the Permanent Council of the Organization of American States include a presentation of the enclosed Thirty-Eighth Report of the OAS Mission to Support the Peace Process in Colombia (MAPP/OAS), pursuant to resolution CP/RES. 859 (1397/04), whereby the Organization of American States requested the Secretary General to report periodically to the Permanent Council on the work of the Mission. Please find herewith the report in Spanish and English. It should be noted that the thirty-eighth MAPP Report will be distributed in Spanish and English as soon as the presentation is approved.

We would like to deliver the report this coming June 18.

Accept, Excellency, renewed assurances of my highest consideration.

Albert R. Ramdin
Secretary General

CP51876E04

THIRTY-EIGHTH PERIODIC REPORT OF THE SECRETARY GENERAL TO THE PERMANENT COUNCIL ON THE ORGANIZATION OF AMERICAN STATES MISSION TO SUPPORT THE PEACE PROCESS IN COLOMBIA (MAPP/OAS)

The following report is submitted pursuant to Resolution CP/RES. 859 (1397/04), by which the Permanent Council of the Organization of American States (OAS) requests that the Secretary General report on the work of the OAS Mission to Support the Peace Process in Colombia¹ (MAPP/OAS or the Mission) on a regular basis.

The information² covers the findings obtained between July 1 and December 31, 2024, a period during which the Mission carried out 943 field missions, covering 275 population centers in 171 municipalities in 25 of the country's departments. These population centers included municipal capitals, administrative districts (*corregimientos*), villages (*veredas*), indigenous reserves (*resguardos*), and community councils. During this period, MAPP/OAS teams traveled 130,100 kilometers by land and 1,527 kilometers by river.

The OAS General Secretariat (GS/OAS) wishes to highlight and express its gratitude for the financial and political support of the member states and observers that make up the "Basket Fund"—Canada, Chile, Germany, Ireland, Italy, the Netherlands, Spain, Sweden, Turkey, the United Kingdom, and the United States—which makes the presence of the MAPP/OAS possible. The international community's steady support is a determining factor in the short and medium term for Colombia and is essential to ensure the Mission's sustainability in the territories. The GS/OAS likewise recognizes the contributions of Norway and Switzerland, which strengthen the work of the MAPP/OAS in essential areas such as citizen participation and dialogue. Finally, it thanks the governments of Argentina, Germany, and Switzerland for providing talent through secondments of personnel,³ people who contribute to the country and the Mission with their values and expertise.

1. GENERAL CONSIDERATIONS

The MAPP/OAS thanks Luis Almagro Lemes, the outgoing OAS Secretary General, for his leadership, trust, and steadfast support, which allowed the Mission to have the backing of the Americas and the rest of the international community to contribute toward building a complete peace in Colombia.

The MAPP/OAS welcomes and extends its greetings to Albert Ramdin, the Secretary General-elect of the OAS for the 2025-2030 period. The Mission's work, knowledge, capabilities, and experience are at the disposal of the Secretary General to contribute to the achievement of the Organization's priorities and the fulfillment of its principles. It is at the OAS where the member states and observers can come together to address regional challenges jointly and to move forward, with determination and a sense of solidarity, in the construction of peace.

The GS/OAS values the Colombian government's actions to guarantee women's human rights, which reflect its commitment to the Women, Peace, and Security Agenda, strengthen capacities for the political participation of indigenous, Black, Afro-descendent, Palenquera, and Raizal women, and help to position them as protagonists in the construction of peace.

¹ The mandate of the MAPP/OAS derives from the agreement entered into by the Government of the Republic of Colombia and the OAS General Secretariat, signed on January 23, 2004, and Resolution CP/RES.859 (1397/04) adopted by the Permanent Council on February 6, 2004. The mandate has been expanded and extended nine times and was most recently signed on May 30, 2024, extending the duration of the Mission until January 24, 2027.

² This report uses general categories such as public servants, minors, Colombians, teachers, settlers, or members of armed groups, among others, in order to facilitate the reading of the text. However, it is important to clarify that these terms include women, men, boys, girls, adolescents, people who belong to ethnic communities, people with diverse sexual orientations, and people with disabilities. This caveat is made in recognition and respect for differential approaches, noting the importance of mainstreaming these approaches to be able to understand and adequately serve all these populations.

³ Through secondments, countries assign professionals of their nationality to perform jobs for a specific period of time.

Among the steps taken to mainstream a gender approach are the "Cristina Bautista Taquinas" Course on Regular Elections and Indigenous Peoples' Governments of Latin America, organized in partnership with the OAS Inter-American Commission of Women and the Ministry of Equality and Equity; advances in territorializing the Comprehensive Program of Guarantees for Women Leaders and Human Rights Defenders in several departments; the implementation of the National Action Plan of Resolution 1325 for Colombia, developed with the participation of more than 1,500 women from across the country; and the approval by the Congress of the Republic of Law 2364 of 2024, which recognizes the work and the rights of women who search for victims of forced disappearance as builders of peace and persons with special constitutional protection.

This progress stands in contrast to the ongoing dynamics of violence generated by armed groups⁴ against women, including sexual violence, trafficking for sexual exploitation, forced displacement, confinement, imposition of payments, torture, kidnappings, and homicides. These harmful impacts had differentiated effects on migrant women, girls and adolescents, and women belonging to ethnic communities, as well as on their families and the social fabric of their communities.

With respect to peace talks and initiatives in Colombia and efforts to implement the Total Peace Policy at the territorial level, the peace talks between the national government and *Comuneros del Sur*, also known as the Roundtable for the Joint Construction of Territorial Peace in Nariño, reached agreements regarding the Local and Temporary Bilateral Cease-fire and the destruction of that armed group's war materiel. The MAPP/OAS monitors this process on an ongoing basis, together with the Embassy of the Kingdom of the Netherlands and the Catholic Church, and to this end it expanded its presence and territorial coverage with the opening of a new regional office in Samaniego, Nariño. The Mission also provided technical assistance in developing the agreements and protocols and monitored the reception and verification of the war materiel, thus contributing to the effective implementation of this commitment.

As part of the discussions between the Government of Colombia and the Gaitanista Self-Defense Forces of Colombia (*Autodefensas Gaitanistas de Colombia*), municipal and departmental authorities, social leaders, and representatives of different productive sectors in Antioquia, Córdoba, La Guajira, and Santander were invited by the national government to listening sessions to identify the impacts of this armed group's actions and receive recommendations for the development of this peace initiative. The MAPP/OAS provided support in this process.

In the peace process between the Government of Colombia and the National Coordinator of the Bolivarian Army (*Coordinadora Nacional Ejército Bolivariano*), following its separation from the *Segunda Marquetalia*, the parties held their first meeting, in which the armed group ratified its commitment to maintain a unilateral cease-fire. The GS/OAS calls on the national government and the *Segunda Marquetalia* to continue seeking rapprochement and to resume dialogue as a fundamental principle toward peace.

The MAPP/OAS also continued to monitor the peace talks between the Government of Colombia and the High Command of the Comandante Jorge Suárez Briceño Bloc, the Magdalena Medio Comandante Gentil Duarte Bloc, and the Raúl Reyes Front during the V Cycle, in events held in Caquetá, Guaviare, Meta, and Norte de Santander, as well as in the implementation of the bilateral cease-fire.

The signing of the agreement and protocol on citizen participation was one of the main developments achieved by the delegations. It will be important to implement and spread the word about these instruments in the territories so that they can meet their objectives and promote participatory processes that are safe, diverse, autonomous, and inclusive. In addition, the GS/OAS

⁴ The Mission adopts the concept of armed groups and understands it as a generic category that combines the designations contained in legal frameworks (such as Law 2272 of 2022), as well as the forms of self-designation and recognition in the territories. This concept could be adjusted based on the characterization issued by the High-Level Body created by Decree 2655 of 2022.

invites the parties to move forward in developing the 10 thematic pillars defined in the Agreement on the Peacebuilding Agenda, especially the pillar on models of justice and victims' rights, and to ensure compliance with the structural transformations that can contribute to overcoming the armed conflict.

With regard to the Social and Legal Discussion Forums (*Espacios de Conversación Sociojurídica*) in Buenaventura, Quibdó, and Medellín and the Aburrá Valley, the MAPP/OAS monitored different forums held between delegations of the national government and urban armed groups, where progress was made on issues such as the approval of operational protocols, truces, civil society participation, and socioeconomic initiatives.

Faced with the challenges of the peace talks between the Government of Colombia and the National Liberation Army (*Ejército de Liberación Nacional*), the Peace Office (*Gestoría de Paz*), supported by the MAPP/OAS along with the GPAAC⁵ and Norway, continued to be a useful mechanism and communication channel in the search for peaceful, negotiated solutions to the armed conflict.

The GS/OAS is grateful for the invitations extended to the MAPP/OAS to provide political and technical support for all these peace initiatives, and reaffirms its commitment to do so with respect, autonomy, and impartiality, making available its knowledge and capabilities to strengthen dialogue and build sustainable, viable agreements with a transformative impact on the territories.

Eight years after the signing of the Final Peace Agreement, the GS/OAS draws attention to steps forward such as the implementation of the territorialization strategy of the National Agrarian Reform and Rural Development System, derived from Point 1; the functioning of the Coordination Unit (*Instancia de Articulación*) between the national government and the Special Jurisdiction for Peace (*Jurisdicción Especial para la Paz*, JEP), which seeks to coordinate restoration activities; and the JEP's indictment of six former members of the former FARC-EP Secretariat for the recruitment and abuse of children, according to Order No. 05 of 2024. Nevertheless, the GS/OAS expresses its concern over the persistent harmful impacts on peace signatories and their families, who continue to be victims of homicides, threats, confinements, forced displacements, and kidnappings. The commitment to peace demands that the state take firm action to safeguard the life and integrity of this population.

The Colombian state has made progress in its efforts to contribute to truth, justice, and reparation for the victims of the armed conflict. It is imperative to implement changes and transformations that will speed up the processes and procedures underway. Ensuring that the transitional justice mechanisms that are in force in the country advance efficiently and effectively will allow them to achieve their objectives: to facilitate the peace processes and the transition to civilian life of members of armed groups and to satisfy the rights of victims to justice, provide them with the truth, and contribute to their reparation.

The GS/OAS warns of the resurgence of the armed conflict and the recurrence of direct harm to the life, liberty, integrity, security, and property of the civilian population, particularly in Antioquia, Arauca, Bolívar, Cauca, Chocó, Córdoba, Guaviare, Nariño, Norte de Santander, Putumayo, and Valle del Cauca. This escalation of violence is due to ongoing territorial disputes between armed groups, as well as to fragmentation within their structures.

The GS/OAS takes note of state actions in the area of security, such as Operation Perseus in the Micay River Canyon in Cauca, Operation Cordillera in Nariño, and the deployment of Rapid Deployment Force units in Norte de Santander. It is important to complement these actions with the provision of services by civil institutions to counteract the violence against the population and improve the security and development conditions in the territories.

⁵ Group of Support, Accompaniment, and Cooperation Countries (*Grupo de Países de Apoyo, Acompañamiento y Cooperación*), made up of Germany, Spain, Switzerland, and Sweden.

The GS/OAS also warns about the expansion and diversification of strategies of forced recruitment, use and abuse of children and adolescents, and sexual violence against them by armed groups. Children as young as 10 years old, especially from indigenous and Afro-descendent communities, were more intensely affected. In northern and northeastern Antioquia, the Pacific coast of Cauca, southern Bolívar, and southern Córdoba, the armed groups turned to social media to recruit children and adolescents and get them involved in their organizations.

Public servants were also victims of homicides, forced displacements, threats, and extortion by armed groups, which led to a weakened institutional presence in the territories. In Nariño, the local ombudsman (*personero*) of Cumbitara was murdered and the mayor and her cabinet were threatened, resulting in their forced displacement. In Catatumbo and southern Bolívar, the groups restricted the access and mobility of state institutions and international and humanitarian organizations, and in Caquetá, Guaviare, and Meta, they prevented the entry of public servants working on the Comprehensive Rural Reform, among other incidents that reflect the exercise of violence against the population and institutions.

The GS/OAS recalls that the work of public servants is vital to ensure the presence of the state, the provision of essential services, and the protection of citizens' rights. It also reiterates that it is imperative to ensure the protection of civil servants and ensure favorable working conditions. Democracy is built on solid institutions and respect for those who represent them.

In spite of the state's efforts to prevent harm and protect social leaders, there was still a high risk involved in engaging in community action and defending the environment, human rights, and the territory, among other advocacy efforts, mainly in areas of territorial disputes between armed groups and in places where military and humanitarian actions were carried out.

In border areas, the Colombian population and migrants were victims of homicides, kidnappings, human trafficking, migrant smuggling, sexual violence, forced disappearance, and enlistment by armed groups. As a result of different measures implemented by the states, the Colombian population perceived that along the border with Panama there was a decrease in the overland flow of migrants seeking to reach the United States. This is in contrast with the trend seen in Buenaventura in Valle del Cauca, where authorities and communities pointed to an increase in irregular transit toward the same destination.

Against this backdrop, the GS/OAS urgently calls for an end to the violence in the country and for the implementation of coordinated, contextualized, comprehensive, and preventive actions geared toward protecting the civilian population in urban settings, border areas, and especially in rural areas. The interdependence and transnational impact of the problems of violence are exacerbating security challenges in the region. Confronting these threats and strengthening peace in Colombia is a shared responsibility that requires a renewed commitment from the international community, especially from the countries of the region.

The actions of armed groups continued to cause environmental damage to strategic ecosystems. Deforestation and contamination of water sources due to the illegal extraction of mineral deposits and the discharge of hydrocarbons and chemicals used in the processing of cocaine base (*pasta base de coca*) were some of the effects caused in Antioquia, Arauca, Bolívar, Caquetá, Cauca, Chocó, Córdoba, Guaviare, Meta, Nariño, Norte de Santander, Putumayo, and Valle del Cauca. In some regions within these departments, armed groups continued to impose restrictions on the use and care of natural resources.

The preservation of biodiversity and the protection of strategic ecosystems require urgent and sustainable actions, as well as the implementation of the commitments made by Colombia under the Escazú Agreement on preventing risks and protecting environmental leaders.

On another point, Colombian institutions have made it a priority to address social conflicts as a pillar for peacebuilding in Colombia. This commitment requires making progress toward appropriate linkages, coordination, and complementarity among the national, departmental, and

municipal levels; it also requires the definition of legal tools and the strengthening of capacities for social dialogue, which will allow the development of sustainable agreements.

The MAPP/OAS provides state institutions and organized expressions of civil society with capacity building for participation, dialogue, conflict transformation, and development of consensus, one of the four forms of support endorsed in the Ninth Protocol signed between the Government of the Republic of Colombia and the OAS, which renewed the Mission's mandate until January 24, 2027.

As they seek to overcome challenges and consolidate achievements in the search for peace, Colombians are not alone. For all Colombians and for their rights, the GS/OAS renews its commitment to continue supporting initiatives to implement and territorialize the Total Peace Policy. The will and solidarity manifested in the presence of the MAPP/OAS is a reminder of the value of every action on the road to a peace that transcends time and results in more rights for more people in the Americas.

2. SECURITY CONDITIONS ASSOCIATED WITH THE PRESENCE AND ACTIONS OF ARMED GROUPS

The information in this section is the result of efforts by the MAPP/OAS to monitor security conditions, and it refers to the actions of the various armed groups: the Blocs and Front High Command (*Estado Mayor de los Bloques y Frente*, EMBF),⁶ Central High Command (*Estado Mayor Central*, EMC),⁷ National Liberation Army (*Ejército de Liberación Nacional*, ELN), *Comuneros del Sur* (CS), United Self-Defense Forces of Nariño (*Autodefensas Unidas de Nariño*, AUN), *Segunda Marquetalia* (SM), National Coordinator of the Bolivarian Army (*Coordinadora Nacional Ejército Bolivariano*, CNEB), Gaitanista Self-Defense Forces of Colombia (*Autodefensas Gaitanistas de Colombia*, AGC),⁸ and the Conquering Self-Defense Forces of the Sierra Nevada (*Autodefensas Conquistadores de la Sierra Nevada*, ACSN).

The presence of these armed groups continued to be directly related to their utilization of geographical conditions for internal security and the possibility of extracting economic resources through extortion, drug-related activities,⁹ and illegal mining. The latter two in particular have caused environmental damage through contamination of water sources and deforestation.

The EMBF continued participating in the peace talks (*Mesa de Diálogos de Paz*, MDP) and maintained the Bilateral and Temporary Cease-fire with Respect for the Civilian Population¹⁰ with the national government. This armed group was present in municipalities in Antioquia, Bolívar, Caquetá, Guaviare, Huila, Meta, Norte de Santander, and Putumayo.

⁶ This armed group is made up of the Comandante Jorge Suárez Briceño Bloc, the Magdalena Medio Comandante Gentil Duarte Bloc, and the Raúl Reyes Front.

⁷ This armed group brings together the Martín Villa Joint Eastern Command (*Comando Conjunto de Oriente Martín Villa*), the Manuel Marulanda Vélez Amazon Region Bloc (*Bloque Amazonas Manuel Marulanda Vélez*), the Isaías Pardo Central Bloc (*Bloque Central Isaías Pardo*), and the Jacobo Arenas Western Bloc (*Bloque Occidental Jacobo Arenas*).

⁸ On February 24, 2024, this armed group published a video calling itself the Gaitanista Army of Colombia (*Ejército Gaitanista de Colombia*), replacing its previous self-designation as the Gaitanista Self-Defense Forces of Colombia (*Autodefensas Gaitanistas de Colombia*), with which it had been recognized since its beginnings. Additionally, some state institutions identify it as the Gulf Clan (*Clan del Golfo*), and others continue to use the name AGC (for example, in Resolution 257 of 2024). In this report, the Mission will refer to the group's self-designated name of Gaitanista Self-Defense Forces of Colombia.

⁹ The Mission understands drug-related activities to mean those associated with the planting of illicit crops and their processing for the production, transport, and marketing of illicit drugs, which may involve armed groups and mafias, among others.

¹⁰ On October 15, through Decree 1280 of 2024, the Bilateral and Temporary Cease-fire with Respect for the Civilian Population between the Government of Colombia and the High Command of the Comandante Jorge Suárez Briceño Bloc, the Magdalena Medio Comandante Gentil Duarte Bloc, and the Raúl Reyes Front was extended until April 15, 2025. Available at: <https://lc.cx/Z2cEmY>

The EMC remained outside the peace talks and concentrated its actions in municipalities in Arauca, Caquetá, Cauca, Guaviare, Huila, Meta, Nariño, Tolima, Putumayo, and Valle del Cauca.

The ELN had a presence in municipalities in Antioquia, Arauca, Bolívar, Chocó, Cauca, Norte de Santander, and Valle del Cauca.

The CS concentrated its actions in the regions of Abades and Guambuyaco in the department of Nariño. In mid-2024, this group, which at that time called itself the *Frente Comuneros del Sur*, announced its separation from the ELN and its decision to move forward with a peace dialogue process. In September, the Roundtable for the Joint Construction of Territorial Peace in Nariño (*Mesa para la Co-construcción de Paz Territorial en Nariño*) was set up between the national government and *Comuneros del Sur*.

For its part, the AUN, a group that made itself known before the start of the Roundtable for the Joint Construction of Territorial Peace between the national government and the CS, had a presence in the department of Nariño, mainly in the regions of Abades, Cordillera, and Guambuyaco.

In November, as peace talks were unfolding between the national government and the SM, a division emerged within this armed group. One faction that was present in municipalities in Huila and Caquetá continued under the name *Segunda Marquetalia* and disassociated itself from the process. On the other hand, the Border Commands-Bolivarian Army (*Comandos de la Frontera-Ejército Bolivariano*) and the Guerrilla Coordinator of the Pacific (*Coordinadora Guerrillera del Pacífico*), present in parts of Cauca, Nariño, Putumayo, and Valle del Cauca, announced that they would continue in the peace talks and adopted the name *Coordinadora Nacional Ejército Bolivariano*.

The AGC concentrated its actions in municipalities in Antioquia, Bolívar, Chocó, Córdoba, La Guajira, Magdalena, and Valle del Cauca.

The ACSN had a presence in the Sierra Nevada de Santa Marta region, involving municipalities in La Guajira and Magdalena.

Fragmentation within armed groups led to the emergence of new circumstances related to territorial disputes. EMC and EMBF structures clashed in Caquetá and Guaviare;¹¹ likewise, the CNEB maintained disputes with the EMC along the Pacific coast of Nariño and the Micay River Canyon and in Putumayo with the EMBF.

Meanwhile, the AUN, in alliance with the CS, clashed with the EMC in the Cordillera region of Nariño. In turn, the 57th Yair Bermúdez Front – Bolivarian Army,¹² recently incorporated into the CNEB, clashed with EMC structures in the northeast of Cauca and in the center and south of Valle del Cauca.

Tensions escalated between the ELN and the EMBF's 33rd Front in Catatumbo, in Norte de Santander, in November 2024. In January 2025, this situation triggered an offensive action by the ELN, which led to clashes between both groups and resulted in homicides, kidnappings, threats, forced displacements, and confinements of the civilian population, with social leaders and peace signatories particularly affected.¹³

¹¹ Clashes occurred in this department in mid-January 2025 in the rural area of the municipality of Calamar.

¹² During the first half of 2024, this group strengthened its presence in municipalities in central Valle del Cauca. At that time, some hypotheses suggested that this was a structure that originated from fragmentation within the Adán Izquierdo Front of the EMC's Isaías Pardo Bloc, while others attributed it to divisions within the Dagoberto Ramos Front of the Jacobo Arenas Western Bloc, also of the EMC. As of July 2024, the group called itself the 57th Yair Bermúdez Front – Bolivarian Army [*Frente 57 Yair Bermúdez – Ejército Bolivariano*].

¹³ The Mission understands peace signatories to be former members of the FARC-EP who were accredited by the Office of the High Commissioner for Peace (now Office of the Peace Commission Adviser) after the signing of the Final Peace Agreement and are active in the reintegration process.

In contrast, the ELN and the EMBF maintained alliances in southern Bolívar, Bajo Cauca, and northern and northeastern Antioquia to confront the AGC. The latter armed group continued to clash with the ELN in Chocó and with the ACSN in La Guajira and Magdalena.

In addition, clashes between the ELN and the EMC continued in the department of Arauca, in the northeastern and Pacific coast regions of Cauca, and in Buenaventura in Valle del Cauca.

In the midst of these situations, some armed groups moved around members, including child and adolescent victims of forced recruitment, to strengthen the structures involved in territorial disputes in Antioquia, Arauca, Bolívar, Caquetá, Cauca, Chocó, Guaviare, Huila, Meta, Nariño, Norte de Santander, Putumayo, and Valle del Cauca.

Although the ELN carried out some offensive actions during the Bilateral, National, and Temporary Cease-fire between that group and the national government, after the cease-fire ended in August, such actions intensified, mainly against public security forces¹⁴ and oil infrastructure¹⁵ in Antioquia, Arauca, Boyacá, and Norte de Santander. In the latter department and in Bolívar, the armed group continued to restrict the entry of institutions and international organizations by setting up illegal roadblocks on tertiary roads, where public servants were subjected to searches and had their cell phones checked.

EMC-affiliated structures continued to carry out violent actions through the use of explosive devices, with drones used in some cases. These actions were mainly targeted security forces in Cauca, Huila, Nariño, Tolima, and Valle del Cauca. The indiscriminate nature of these methods inflicted harm on the civilian population, as occurred in Argelia in Cauca and Jamundí in Valle del Cauca.

EMBF factions continued to strengthen their influence in the areas where they had been present and sought to expand into western Norte de Santander, the Cordillera region in Caquetá, and the department of Putumayo along the Caquetá River.

The AGC reinforced its control in the Baudó region in Chocó and Bajo Cauca in Antioquia, as well as its expansion toward the center and north of Valle del Cauca. In regions where it has had an ongoing presence, such as southern Córdoba, this armed group increased its influence over organizational processes.

The security forces strengthened their efforts to counteract the effects of the expansion, fragmentation, and emergence of armed groups. In Arauca, Bolívar, and Norte de Santander, communities and institutions demanded a more active role by military forces and the National Police, while in Antioquia, Caquetá, Cauca, Meta, and Tolima there was an increase in the development of control operations and offensive actions against the armed groups.

In October, the National Army began Operation Perseus in the region of the Micay River in Cauca with the aim of recovering territorial control by public security forces. The Colombian state faces the challenge of accompanying this effort with the deployment of services provided by civilian institutions as a whole.

The armed forces underwent a restructuring and strengthening process with the addition of 16,000 new members, the creation of new Rapid Deployment Forces, the modification of the Joint Commands, and the elimination of the Joint Task Forces and the Caguán, Oriente, and Cauca Specific Commands, whose units were placed under the direct authority of those who command

¹⁴ These included, for example, harassment and ambushes of members of the security forces and attacks on military and police facilities, with the cases in Arauca in Arauca and Anorí in Antioquia standing out for their scale.

¹⁵ The attacks were carried out with explosives and mainly affected the Caño Limón-Coveñas and Bicentenario oil pipelines that go through the departments of Arauca, Boyacá, and Norte de Santander.

the branches of the military to which they belong. The Ministry of Defense stated that the changes will make it possible to optimize the planning and execution of operations.¹⁶

3. HARMFUL IMPACTS ON THE CIVILIAN POPULATION¹⁷

The armed groups continued to violate the rights to life, liberty, personal integrity, security, and property of the civilian population. In situations involving armed confrontation, the groups failed to respect the principle of distinction and used educational institutions, land parcels, and homes as places of refuge from military actions. They also took food for themselves, took control of property used to provide public services,¹⁸ and forced civilians to provide them with lodging, sell them products, and store weapons.

In Antioquia, Caquetá, Norte de Santander, and Valle del Cauca, the armed groups left messages and graffiti alluding to their presence on homes, gas stations, and vehicles. Their use of civilian property put the communities at risk of being stigmatized as informants or collaborators of other groups. In Arauca, Antioquia, Huila, Nariño, and Norte de Santander, the groups attacked commercial establishments, vehicles, and homes with bursts of gunfire and explosive devices in retaliation against the civilian population for rebuffing threats and impositions of payment and with the intention of harassing members of enemy groups.

The armed groups took houses, farms, and commercial establishments from the civilian population. These properties were used for cattle ranching, setting up camps, planting illicit crops, and extracting mineral deposits. This impact took the form of direct purchase of land by members of the groups,¹⁹ the surrender of land as payment for impositions,²⁰ and the abandonment of land due to forced displacement by intimidation. In Catatumbo, women heads of household were threatened with the forced recruitment of their sons and daughters if they did not abandon their property.

In parts of Antioquia, Arauca, Córdoba, Chocó, Guaviare, Meta, Nariño, Norte de Santander, Putumayo, Tolima, and Valle del Cauca, forced displacements occurred on both an individual and mass scale;²¹ these particularly affected minors, women, teachers, peace signatories, and campesino and ethnic communities. These population groups were forced to abandon their homes, livelihoods, and community environments in search of protection from the risk of being victims of other harmful impacts. Despite the complex security conditions, some families returned to their territories without institutional support, given the precariousness and perceived risk in the places where they had taken refuge, or returned temporarily to check the condition of their property.

Likewise, communities continued to be subject to confinements,²² due to the presence and incursion of groups and clashes between them; the fear of contamination from improvised explosive devices (IEDs); and the imposition of restrictions on movement, as occurred with the

¹⁶ Office of the President of the Republic of Colombia (2024). “Changes made to reorganize the military forces do not weaken them: national government.” Available at: <https://www.presidencia.gov.co/prensa/Paginas/Cambios-para-reorganizar-las-Fuerzas-Militares-no-las-debilita-Gobierno-Nacional-241105.aspx>

¹⁷ The Mission understands the term harmful impacts (*afectaciones*) to mean violent actions, deeds, and conduct perpetrated in the context of the Colombian armed conflict and the criminal behavior threatening the life, liberty, personal integrity, security, and property of the civilian population.

¹⁸ Such property includes aqueducts, roads, parks, seawalls, power grids, educational institutions, community centers (*casetas comunales*), churches, oil pipelines, and machinery used for public works.

¹⁹ This happened in Patía and Santander de Quilichao in Cauca, Tierralta in Córdoba, and Tibú in Norte de Santander. In Catatumbo, some residents sold their properties to members of armed groups, who in some cases bought them at low prices and in others bartered them for cocaine base.

²⁰ The Mission understands the imposition of payment as an action taken by the armed groups against the civilian population to extort or exact payment in order to obtain illicit profit or some kind of benefit.

²¹ Article 2.2.2.5.1 of Decree 1084 of 2015 defines a mass forced displacement as one involving 10 or more family members or 50 or more people.

²² In regions of Antioquia, Arauca, Bolívar, Caquetá, Cauca, Chocó, Córdoba, Meta, Putumayo, and Valle del Cauca.

armed strikes (*paros armados*)²³ carried out in the San Juan region in Chocó, which particularly affected ethnic communities and authorities. This situation disrupted the supply of basic necessities, which had an impact on food security and the economy, in addition to limiting the arrival of humanitarian aid and international organizations.

In the south of Córdoba and Valle del Cauca, the armed groups forced the civilian population to obstruct law enforcement operations and judicial proceedings against illegal mining.

In Arauca, Chocó, and Nariño, the groups' actions gave rise to fear in the communities and limited their ability to move about the territories, carry out daily activities, use electronic devices, and interact with foreigners. The lack of complaints and the underreporting of cases involving forced displacement and confinement persisted due to the potential for reprisals by the armed groups.

The imposition of payments on the extraction of mineral deposits and the trade in timber, food, alcoholic beverages, fuel, and gas was a recurring impact. Victims sometimes were forced to pay more than one armed group.

The armed groups kidnapped members of communities in Antioquia, Arauca, Guaviare, Meta, Norte de Santander, and Valle del Cauca in order to demand money, goods, and payment of debts, as well as to determine any possible links between the victims and other armed groups or the security forces. In some cases, the release of these individuals was used to send messages to the national government about peace talks and initiatives.

In Antioquia, Arauca, Cauca, Córdoba, Norte de Santander, Nariño, and Valle del Cauca, the armed groups continued to inflict harm on the civilian population through forced disappearance. Some victims' bodies were found on roads, highways, or in border areas.

The armed groups continued to impose restrictions and sanctions on the communities in order to strengthen their control, taking on the functions of institutional authorities. They also continued to limit the civilian population's mobility by setting up illegal roadblocks and demanding that people carry a card identifying them as area residents. In terms of citizen coexistence, they limited economic activity, prohibited the use of illicit drugs, and interfered in community dynamics and in the redirection of public investment.

Peace signatories and their families continued to be victims of homicides, threats, confinement, forced displacement, kidnapping, and stigmatization. The risk of falling victim intensified in situations in which people refused to join the armed groups or were subject to unfounded accusations of committing crimes or of collaborating with the security forces or with other groups.

In San Vicente del Caguán in Caquetá, an armed group threatened and forcibly displaced peace signatories from the Former Territorial Training and Reintegration Area (*Antiguo Espacio Territorial de Capacitación y Reincorporación*, AETCR) in Miravalle. In response to this situation, in August the national government relocated this AETCR to El Doncello in Caquetá, accompanied by the MAPP/OAS.

Women were victims of sexual violence, trafficking for sexual exploitation, forced displacement, confinement, impositions of payment, torture, kidnapping, and homicide. These harms had a differentiated impact on Colombian and migrant women, girls, and adolescents, as well as on women who belong to ethnic communities. In Arauca, Chocó, Guaviare, Meta, and Norte de Santander, the armed groups perpetrated violence against the women after accusing them of being romantically involved with members of the security forces, other armed groups, or peace signatories.

²³ The Mission construes an armed strike as the pronouncements and actions carried out by armed groups during a certain period of time that have an impact on security conditions and lead to confinements, forced displacements, and restrictions on movement with humanitarian consequences.

3.1. Harmful impacts on social leaders²⁴ and public servants

The Office of the Inspector General (*Procuraduría General de la Nación*) issued Directive 005 of July 8, 2024,²⁵ and implemented the Index for Prevention of Threat Risks to Social Leaders, thereby strengthening the tools for monitoring and evaluating public policy on harm prevention and protecting leaders and human rights defenders. These directives provide public institutions with assessments and guidelines for the protection of this population.²⁶

The National Protection Unit (UNP), for its part, strengthened the prevention component with its Protective Environments Strategy in Nariño and Cauca²⁷ and carried out actions in response to alerts from Lifeline 103.²⁸ In the area of protection, the UNP addressed the recommendations for technical support to territorial entities made by the Early Warning System of the Office of the Human Rights Ombudsman (*Defensoría del Pueblo*); granted 3,017 individual protection plans and 85 collective measures; and held 300 training sessions in self-protection for social leaders, ethnic communities, public servants, and teachers.²⁹

Despite these efforts, the risks involved in being social leaders and doing human rights defense work persisted, mainly in areas where there are territorial dispute between armed groups and in places where military and humanitarian actions were carried out.

The armed groups coerced and constrained social leaders so that the communities would comply with impositions such as ID badge requirements, movement schedules, authorization for entry of foreigners, management of natural resources, implementation of community works, meeting notices, control over interaction with institutions, and affiliation with groups and campesino guards. In addition, leaders were used to disseminate messages against other leaders, social organizations, public servants, journalists, and political parties in order to hinder their work.

Social leaders who questioned the armed groups' impositions, refused to comply with them, or took steps to prevent violence faced serious risks, including homicides,³⁰ threats, forced displacement, torture, and other rights violations.

In Arauca, Cauca, Nariño, Norte de Santander, and Putumayo, women leaders who participated in the recovery of child victims of forced recruitment, the search for missing persons, and the release of kidnapees were victims of violence on the part of the armed groups, which hampered their role as human rights defenders and their advocacy agendas.

Social leaders continued to be stigmatized for attending institutional activities, humanitarian aid deliveries, citizen consultation roundtables, and participation forums held in the context of the Total Peace Policy in Arauca, Cauca, Guaviare, Meta, Nariño, and Norte de Santander.

Public servants were also victims of homicides, threats, forced displacement, and extortion. In Arauca, Cauca, and Nariño, the armed groups' actions led to resignations, difficulties in filling vacancies, limited access to rural areas, and the activation of extraction routes, which weakened the institutional presence in the territories. In November, the ombudsman of Cumbitara in Nariño was killed by an armed group. His body was abandoned in a rural area of the municipality along

²⁴ The Mission understands a social leader to mean anyone who carries out any social advocacy activity, whether or not it is connected to an office held within the communities or civil society.

²⁵ Directive 005 of 2024, which updates Directive 002 of 2017, aims to ensure the protection of the fundamental rights of social leaders and human rights defenders and to strengthen the Office of the Inspector General's capacities in the exercise of its functions to protect this population.

²⁶ Office of the Inspector General (2025). Response to request for institutional accomplishments, pp. 12 and 18.

²⁷ National Protection Unit (2025). Response to rights of Petition OFI25-00003975, pp. 2 and 5.

²⁸ The Lifeline (*Línea de Vida*) is a UNP platform for prevention and emergency response available 24 hours a day to people at risk, allowing the Unit to activate immediate response routes. In the second half of 2024, the UNP responded to 321,626 calls. Taken from National Protection Unit (2025). Response to rights of Petition OFI25-00003975, p. 4.

²⁹ National Protection Unit (2025). Response to rights of Petition OFI25-00003975, pp. 3, 4, and 7.

³⁰ Some of the homicides were vicious, especially in the case of representative social leaders capable of drawing crowds, which showed the armed groups' interest in making the civilian population remember them and in spreading fear.

with improvised explosive devices, which injured members of the security forces as they removed the body.

3.2. Forced recruitment, use and abuse of children and adolescents, and sexual violence against them

The Office of the Presidential Adviser for Human Rights and International Humanitarian Law continued to provide technical assistance for the creation and strengthening of Immediate Action Teams in Nariño and Cauca. It also carried out a campaign called *NNAadie más para la guerra* (*No more children and adolescents for the war*) to publicize the problem on social media and motivate citizens to get involved in actions for risk prevention and protection of children and adolescents (NNA in Spanish). The campaign tracked and blocked 150 incidents of social media content that encouraged users to join armed groups.³¹

The Intersectoral Commission for the Prevention of Recruitment, Use, Abuse, and Sexual Violence against Children and Adolescents (CIPRUNNA) and the international community made progress toward implementing a national model of protection standards and the strengthening of community and institutional mechanisms to protect children and adolescents, as well as in carrying out projects in 16 border municipalities aimed at strengthening local capacities for prevention.³²

Between July and December, the Colombian Family Welfare Institute (*Instituto Colombiano de Bienestar Familiar*) attended to 400 minors through the Specialized Care Program for Victims of Illicit Recruitment. It also offered protection and prevention services to 732 minors affected by the armed conflict and provided psychosocial care to 5,794 children and young people through the Migrant Response and Care Teams.³³

Communities and authorities warned of the perceived increase in forced recruitment, use and abuse of children and adolescents, and sexual violence against them perpetrated by the armed groups. Children as young as 10, especially those belonging to indigenous communities³⁴ and those of African descent, were victims of these harms in parts of Antioquia, Arauca, Bolívar, Cauca, Chocó, Córdoba, Guaviare, Meta, Nariño, Norte de Santander, Putumayo, and Valle del Cauca.

Armed groups inflicted sexual violence on adolescents and young women and established coercive emotional relationships as a strategy to get them to join the group. In southern Córdoba, some sources warned that there was a “catalog” of girls as young as 12 for sexual exploitation by members of armed groups.

In northern and northeastern Antioquia, the Pacific coast of Cauca, southern Bolívar, and southern Córdoba, minors skilled in social media and technology were more vulnerable to becoming involved with armed groups. Likewise, the risk continued for adolescents who had dropped out of school, as well as those in an economically vulnerable situation and those involved in coca leaf collection, illicit mining, and migrant smuggling.

The armed groups used family members, romantic partners, human trafficking networks, criminal groups,³⁵ and other child victims to approach minors to get them to join their groups;³⁶

³¹ Office of the Presidential Adviser for Human Rights and International Humanitarian Law (2024). Response of the Office of the Presidential Adviser for Human Rights and International Humanitarian Law. Periodic Report of the Secretary General to the Permanent Council of the Organization of American States (OAS), pp. 2-3.

³² *Ibid.*, p. 3.

³³ Information from the Colombian Family Welfare Institute shared in the comments sent to the MAPP/OAS by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs through official letter S-GAIOM-25-010330 of April 3, 2025.

³⁴ The Embera indigenous peoples in Chocó, Nasa, Misak in Cauca, Awá and Pastos in Nariño, and Eperara Siapidara in Cauca and Nariño.

³⁵ As happened in Jamundí and Buenaventura in Valle del Cauca and Quibdó in Chocó.

³⁶ In the Sarare region in Arauca, commanders of armed groups offered their members and others payments of approximately COP300,000 for each forcibly recruited minor. Likewise, in the Sanquianga region in Nariño, the groups approached minors and youths through invitations to participate in social protests.

sometimes girls were forced to attract new members or perform domestic work and intelligence or military work. These persuasion strategies sought to prevent communities from reporting the use, abuse, and forced recruitment of children.

In Arauca, Bolívar, Cauca, Nariño, and Valle del Cauca, armed groups took adolescents to military training camps under the false pretense of job offers. In addition, in the department of Guaviare and the regions of Bajo Cauca, southern Córdoba, Catatumbo, and southern Valle del Cauca, the armed groups promised children and adolescents that they could live in their homes, continue their studies, or receive military training and later return to their families.

Disputes between armed groups had a negative impact on protective environments such as schools, in the form of threats to teachers and administrators, installation of explosive devices in nearby areas, interruption of classes, and drug dealing, among other examples.

In regions of Antioquia, Bolívar, Cauca, Caquetá, Chocó, Córdoba, Nariño, Putumayo, and Valle del Cauca, underage victims of forced recruitment died in the context of clashes. Especially in Antioquia, Cauca, and Córdoba, children and adolescents who tried to escape from the armed groups were pursued and killed; sometimes their bodies were handed over to their families or found in mass graves.

Due to fear of reprisals and distrust of institutions, the communities continued to fail to report these harms. Some families were forced to displace themselves to protect children and adolescents; in some cases, the risk extended to the municipalities where they sought refuge.

Communities and authorities continued to mention problems regarding the activation of routes or actions designed to attend to the needs of recovered children and adolescents or those at imminent risk of becoming involved with armed groups, as well as the need to strengthen prevention measures.

3.3. Harmful Impacts of Antipersonnel Mines, Unexploded Ordnance, and Booby Traps

The Office of the Peace Commission Adviser (OCCP), through the Decontaminate Colombia team, made progress in implementing the policy for Comprehensive Action against Antipersonnel Mines (AICMA). It advanced in the analysis for updating the Comprehensive Policy for Action against Antipersonnel Mines and CONPES 3567 of 2009, as well as in the gathering of inputs to process the request for an extension to meet Colombia's commitments as a state party to the Ottawa Convention.³⁷

Within the framework of the Safe Schools Convention, 665 educational establishments in Cauca, Chocó, Nariño, and Norte de Santander moved forward in implementing the Mine Risk Education Strategy for Educational Environments and Complementary Assistance to Victims.³⁸

The update of the National Humanitarian Demining Standard facilitated efforts to intervene in areas with instability factors, starting with the public call for risk reduction programs valued at COP9 billion (approximately US\$2,195,000).³⁹ The OCCP prioritized 56 new zones for humanitarian demining and declared 28 zones free of suspected contamination by antipersonnel mines, bringing the number of zones cleared to 41 in 2024. For their part, humanitarian operators continued their work in 84 municipalities.⁴⁰

³⁷ Office of the Peace Commission Adviser (2024). Response of the Peace Commission Adviser (CCP). Progress, Achievements, and Results: Semiannual Report 38 - Periodic Report of the Secretary General to the OAS Permanent Council), p. 20.

³⁸ *Ibid.*, p. 21.

³⁹ This calculation uses an exchange rate of US\$1=COP4,100 as a reference value.

⁴⁰ Office of the Peace Commission Adviser (2025). Response of the Peace Commission Adviser (CCP). Progress, Achievements, and Results: Semiannual Report 38 - Periodic Report of the Secretary General to the OAS Permanent Council), p. 20.

Official sources reported 40 new victims of antipersonnel mines, for a total of 105 people affected in 2024, a figure that confirms the trend towards a decline in the number of victims since 2021.⁴¹ These devices harmed civilians and the security forces in Antioquia, Arauca, Cauca, Chocó, Córdoba, Bolívar, Nariño, Norte de Santander, Putumayo, and Valle del Cauca. The lingering contamination from land mines and unexploded ordnance also affected members of armed groups in Bajo Cauca in Antioquia.

The armed groups continued to use antipersonnel mines and unexploded ordnance because they are easy to plant and are capable of causing major damage. These devices were used to create defensive fences in encampment zones, areas of dispute, areas of transit of other groups and security forces, and places where there is illegal mining, illegal extraction of crude oil, and drug-related activities.

Antipersonnel mines and unexploded ordnance were also placed in schools, roads, areas along rivers, agricultural crops, aqueducts, and housing in regions of Antioquia, Arauca, Bolívar, Cauca, Chocó, Nariño, Norte de Santander, Putumayo, and Valle del Cauca. Following demands from communities in the Nariño cordillera and southern Bolívar and in the municipality of Cáceres in Antioquia, armed groups removed devices from public infrastructure used every day, such as sewers, roads, and bridges.

The recurrent use of booby traps hidden in signs, flags, motorcycles, and vehicles as a means to attack security forces continued. One of the cases occurred in Arauquita in Arauca, where an armed group attacked military installations and caused harm to members of the security forces by throwing booby traps from a truck.

The IEDs were directed mainly against military and police units and installations. However, due to their indiscriminate nature, they also inflicted harm on the civilian population. In Argelia in Cauca, after Operation Perseus had begun, a minor died when an IED installed by armed groups in a soccer field was activated.

In Cauca, Putumayo, and Valle del Cauca, armed groups continued to use drones to launch IEDs and increased their military capacity by means of illegal depots for the manufacture of these devices. Particularly in northern Cauca and Guambuyaco in Nariño, they used the civilian population, including minors, to transport explosives.

Unawareness of the location of contaminated zones increased the risk to the communities. In Bajo Cauca in Antioquia, Baudó in Chocó, Catatumbo in Norte de Santander, Ariari in Meta, and Abades and Guambuyaco in Nariño, the groups informed the communities verbally and through posters about the presence of IEDs; in the latter region specifically, they drove the civilian population to keep them from transiting these areas.

In regions of Antioquia and Arauca, the armed groups used explosive pins or defense wires on farm gates where they camped; these were installed at night and removed in the morning.

The restrictions resulting from IED contamination forced campesino and indigenous communities to modify their daily activities to protect their lives and physical integrity in Antioquia, Arauca, Bolívar, Caquetá, Chocó, Córdoba, Guaviare, Nariño, Putumayo, and Valle del Cauca.

In southern Córdoba and Catatumbo, the civilian population handled IEDs and marked areas where there are suspected antipersonnel mines without having any support or technical knowledge, which increased exposure to potential incidents. Moreover, the reactivated cocaine base trade raised the risk that the civilian population will return to abandoned illicit-crop lands contaminated by antipersonnel mines on the Pacific coast and cordillera of Nariño and in Baudó in Chocó.

⁴¹ Office of the Peace Commission Adviser (2025). Available at: https://lc.cx/QIy_xU

The communities continued to express a lack of awareness, distrust, and perception of delayed response or negligence regarding the implementation of prevention and protection actions in the face of risks from antipersonnel mines, unexploded ordnance, and booby traps in Antioquia, Bolívar, Cauca, Chocó, and Nariño.

4. PEACE INITIATIVES, DISCUSSIONS, AND DIALOGUES

The Total Peace Policy made progress in implementing its territorial approach in several initiatives, discussions, and dialogues between the national government and the armed groups. These processes have aimed to establish agreements to put an end to the harmful impacts on the civilian population, ensure the presence of institutions for the transformation of the territories, and guarantee the rights of the victims, as well as to strengthen confidence in institutions and the legitimacy of the peace policies.

The national government faces the challenge of consolidating a strategy of political, communicational, and operational coordination for the implementation of the processes and compliance with the agreements reached. This requires budget allocations specifically earmarked for peace, for assertive institutional communication, and the participation of mayors' and governors' offices in the initiatives, discussions, and dialogues. It continues to be essential for the parties to take on and fulfill commitments to ensure the security of communities and public servants in the territories prioritized for implementation of the agreements.

Similarly, there is still a need to adjust and create legal frameworks that facilitate the transition to civilian life for members of the armed groups. The peace agreements should also consider strengthening the ordinary criminal justice system to ensure, in addition to transitional justice, the proper prosecution of the most serious and representative crimes and of those who do not meet the requirements for access to transitional mechanisms. This would contribute to the legal sustainability of the agreements and would help overcome impunity.

4.1. Peace talks between the Government of Colombia and the High Command of the Comandante Jorge Suárez Briceño Bloc, the Magdalena Medio Comandante Gentil Duarte Bloc, and the Comandante Raúl Reyes Front

The GS/OAS notes that the EMBF (Blocs and Front High Command) continues to participate in the peace talks and recognizes the overcoming of the crisis⁴² as a reflection of the delegations' capacity to deal with contingencies, establish priorities, and maintain dialogue as a fundamental principle and preferred path to peace. The MAPP/OAS ratifies its commitment to support the peace talks using its experience and capacity to influence.

In Cycle VI of the talks, the delegations approved the agreement⁴³ and protocol⁴⁴ for citizen, social, and community participation. The agreement established commitments for autonomous and safe participation, as well as the creation of a thematic committee to manage the participatory process. The protocol specified that each participation forum must include a clear objective and formal invitations and include logistical and administrative aspects, as well as a strategy for monitoring the commitments reached.

⁴² The crisis resulted from fragmentation within the armed group because of dissent over its continued participation in the peace talks after the national government suspended the Bilateral and Temporary National Cease-fire with Territorial Impact (CFBTNT) in Cauca, Nariño, and Valle del Cauca in March 2024.

⁴³ Peace talks between the Government of Colombia and the High Command of the Comandante Jorge Suárez Briceño Bloc, the Magdalena Medio Comandante Gentil Duarte Bloc, and the Comandante Raúl Reyes Front (2024). Agreement to Ensure Citizen, Social, and Community Participation in the Peace Process between the Government of Colombia and the High Command of the Comandante Jorge Suárez Briceño Bloc, the Magdalena Medio Comandante Gentil Duarte Bloc, and the Comandante Raúl Reyes Front. Available at: <https://lc.cx/mgYnmh>

⁴⁴ Peace talks between the Government of Colombia and the High Command of the Comandante Jorge Suárez Briceño Bloc, the Magdalena Medio Comandante Gentil Duarte Bloc, and the Comandante Raúl Reyes Front (2024). Protocol for Citizen, Social, and Community Participation in the Peace Process between the Government of Colombia and the High Command of the Comandante Jorge Suárez Briceño Bloc, the Magdalena Medio Comandante Gentil Duarte Bloc, and the FARCE-EP Comandante Raúl Reyes Front. Available at: <https://lc.cx/mgYnmh>

Despite the above, the commitments established in these documents were applied partially, which led to a decline in the quality of participation, additional risks to attendees, and deterioration of the credibility of the talks.

Institutional capacities and the dynamics of the EMBF in each territory determined the methodology employed in the dialogue sessions with communities and the level of progress in the implementation of partial agreements. Moreover, the scant dissemination of protocols, the security risk stemming from the participation of the civilian population, and the asymmetry in the results of actions for territorial transformation had a negative impact on trust and on the perception of the capacity of the peace talks to manage the commitments made.

The model of commissions made up of delegations from both parties enabled progress to be made in the planning and execution of concrete steps for the implementation of the territorial transformation plans of Sabanas del Yari; Catatumbo; north, northeast, and Bajo Cauca of Antioquia; southern Bolívar; southern Meta and San José del Guaviare; and northwest area of Serranía de Chiribiquete National Natural Park.

In the Sabanas del Yari area, the territorial transformation plan includes the formalization of land titles, collective productive projects, and road, education, and health infrastructure. In the case of Catatumbo, the initiatives include the provision of educational and health institutions, productive and reforestation projects, humanitarian demining, and community infrastructure. In the north, northeast, and Bajo Cauca of Antioquia, the territorial transformation initiatives focus on a reforestation project involving seven municipalities, the development of 21 productive projects, and humanitarian demining, among others.

Despite progress in community consultation, budget allocations, technical studies, and other measures for the implementation of the territorial transformation plans, the perception of communities and local authorities is that the results have not yet had the expected impact.

The need to resolve tensions between environmental protection and agricultural use by communities living in Forest Reserve Zones (ZRF) and National Natural Parks continued to be at the center of debates among delegations. This was the case despite regulatory changes implemented by the National Land Agency that did not come out of the peace talks, such as Agreement 315⁴⁵ and Agreement 337⁴⁶ of 2023, which represent a significant step forward in the legal security demanded by the communities and the environmental protection of the Amazon Region in the face of high rates of deforestation.

The MAPP/OAS invites the peace process to redouble efforts to implement the agreement and protocol on citizen participation, as well as to move forward in defining a political agenda for dialogue that allows for the creation of trust and negotiation on structural transformations that can help to overcome the armed conflict.

4.2. Peace talks between the Government of Colombia and *Comuneros del Sur*

The MAPP/OAS thanks the President of the Republic and the delegations of the national government and the *Comuneros del Sur* for the invitation to be permanent monitors of the peace talks or the Roundtable for the Joint Construction of Territorial Peace in Nariño. Likewise, it ratifies its commitment to be part of the international component of the Monitoring and Verification Mechanism (MMV) of the Local and Temporary Bilateral Cease-fire (CFBLT) and to monitor the destruction of war materiel turned in by the armed groups.

Presidential Resolution 369 of 2024⁴⁷ authorized the installation of the peace talks between the national government and the CS. The process defined a Roadmap for the Joint Construction

⁴⁵ National Land Agency (2023). Agreement 315 of 2023. Available at: <https://lc.cx/v0l9lu>

⁴⁶ National Land Agency (2023). Agreement 315 of 2023. Available at: <https://lc.cx/v0l9lu>

⁴⁷ Office of the President of the Republic (2024). Resolution 369 of 2024. Available at: <https://lc.cx/KOvKCJ>

of Territorial Peace in Nariño, consisting of three pillars: de-escalation of violence; implementation of territorial transformation plans; and CS members' transition to civilian life.

The roundtable held five sessions and signed four agreements and two protocols⁴⁸ on the CFBLT, humanitarian demining, destruction of war materiel, and the search for missing persons. The commitment on this last matter represents an opportunity to move forward in fulfilling the right to truth of the victims and their families.

In terms of territorial transformation, the parties made progress with actions to improve tertiary roads and deliver supplies and furniture for schools and health posts, among other actions. In the component on transformation of illegal economies, especially the illegal extraction of gold deposits, the national government began the analysis and characterization of mining production units and the environmental study needed to create an Agro-mining District for Peace in the municipalities of La Llanada, Los Andes, Mallama, Samaniego, and Santacruz in Nariño.

This district aims to move from illicit economies to agricultural production with a balance among mining, agriculture, and environmental protection, through the formalization of mining activity and the definition of taxation mechanisms, among other measures. It also is contemplating the creation of a people's association for participatory management in the mineral trade and social investment.

Given the presence of other armed groups, the national government faces the challenge of ensuring the protection of the CS delegation and the security of the communities in order to encourage their participation in the activities agreed upon through the peace talks. In this context, it is essential to coordinate actions between the security forces and civilian institutions so as to create safe environments that enable progress on the different pillars.

Mayors' offices and various social sectors have noted the need to implement a mechanism to facilitate their effective participation in the peace talks. The agreement on and implementation of a participation protocol represents an opportunity to involve local authorities and communities in decision-making and to encourage ownership and trust in the process.

4.3. Cease-fire agreements⁴⁹

The Bilateral and Temporary Cease-fire with Respect for the Civilian Population (CFBT) between the national government and the EMBF was extended twice, through Decrees 0888 and 1280 of 2024. The first specified that the cease-fire was in effect between July 16 and October 15, 2024, and the second between October 16, 2024, and April 15, 2025.

The CFBT Oversight, Monitoring, and Verification Mechanism (MVMV) continued to operate through the national office in Bogotá; regional offices in Bucaramanga, Villavicencio, and Mocoa;⁵⁰ and local offices in Anorí and Tibú.

The Ministry of National Defense established a communication protocol with the Office of the Peace Commission Adviser and issued six directives with guidelines to the military and the National Police on implementation of the cease-fires. Also, in coordination with the Police Unit

⁴⁸ The agreements subscribed by the Roundtable for the Joint Construction of Territorial Peace in Nariño are the following: Agreement No. 1; Agreement No. 2, Search for Persons Reported Missing in the Territory; Agreement No. 3, Local and Temporary Bilateral Cease-fire (CFBLT); and Agreement No. 4, Procedure for the Destruction of War Materiel of *Comuneros del Sur*. The agreed-to protocols are: Protocol I on Rules and Commitments for the Local and Temporary Bilateral Cease-fire (CFBLT) and Protocol II on the Mandate of the Technical Monitoring and Verification Mechanism (MMV) in the framework of Agreement No. 3.

⁴⁹ The information in this section is the result of the work of the MAPP/OAS in monitoring territorial dynamics, in fulfillment of its regular mandate in force since 2004. It relates to what has been observed in the regions regarding the impact of the implementation of cease-fires in the framework of peace talks between the Colombian government and the armed groups. Therefore, the perceptions presented are not part of the Mission's roles and commitments in the framework of the monitoring and verification mechanisms created for each process.

⁵⁰ The Mocoa Regional Office, set up in January 2024, has not been able to operate effectively due to the absence of representatives from one of the parties.

for Peacebuilding, the National Protection Unit, and the Office of the Peace Commission Adviser, it provided protection to delegates from the armed groups to the MVMV for them to carry out their work.⁵¹ Even so, it was difficult for some of the regional and local offices to meet due to the need for logistical conditions and protection measures for the EMBF delegation.

In October, the MVMV presented the report for the July to October 2024 period to the peace process. The report noted a reduction in homicides by the EMBF and an increase in prevention actions in compliance with rules and commitments related to respect for the life and liberty of the civilian population.⁵² However, in Antioquia, Bolívar, Caquetá, Guaviare, Huila, Meta, Norte de Santander, and Putumayo, the civilian population and regional institutions questioned the effectiveness of the CFBT due to ongoing homicides, forced displacements, threats, and clashes between the armed groups.

The MVMV prevention procedures allowed the parties, the international component, and monitors to manage, communicate, and act in a timely and coordinated manner in the face of events that could harm the civilian population or lead to confrontations between the security forces and the EMBF. However, there were difficulties with the overall functioning of the MVMV due to delays in the lifting of arrest warrants for the delegates from the armed group and in the establishment of some local offices.⁵³

There is still a need for the parties to create teaching opportunities with the civilian population and regional and local authorities, to provide clear information regarding the rules and commitments under the cease-fire, the functioning of the different offices of the MVMV, and the role of civil society.

Meanwhile, the national government and the CS signed agreements for the implementation of the Local and Temporary Bilateral Cease-fire, with monitoring and technical assistance from the MAPP/OAS. The CFBLT would enter into force once the armed group begins to concentrate in the Temporary Location Zones, and it would have a Monitoring and Verification Mechanism.

4.4. Social and Legal Discussion Forums (ECSJ) in Buenaventura, Quibdó, and Medellín and the Aburrá Valley

Following the national government's appointment of new delegations for the ECSJs in Buenaventura, Quibdó, and Medellín and the Aburrá Valley, discussions with the urban armed groups focused on issues related to the approval of operational protocols, truces, legal matters, civil society participation, and socioeconomic initiatives.

In Buenaventura, the parties made progress in drafting an operational protocol for the ECSJ for the purpose of promoting a peace agreement at the local and national level, aimed at fostering territorial transformation, reducing violence, and facilitating the transition of members of armed groups toward legal status.

The ECSJ also obtained the declaration of a truce between Los Shottas and Los Espartanos from August 5 to November 5, 2024; this was later extended until February 5, 2025. However, armed groups continued to exercise control over some neighborhoods, and there were continued harms such as forced disappearance and extortion.

The ECSJ carried out participation activities with the Black Communities Process (PCN), the Civic Strike Committee, the Universidad del Valle, and the District Mayor's Office of

⁵¹ Ministry of National Defense (2025). Main Achievements, Advances, and Results of the Defense Sector in the Framework of the Policy of Defense, Security, and Citizen Coexistence, Guarantees for Life and Peace (2022-2026), January 31, 2025, p. 3.

⁵² Peace talks between the Government of Colombia and the High Command of the Comandante Jorge Suárez Briceño Bloc, the Magdalena Medio Comandante Gentil Duarte Bloc, and the Raúl Reyes Front (2024). Joint Communiqué Cycle VI of October 18, 2024. Available at: <https://lc.cx/ECRWSb>

⁵³ The local offices pending installation are Cartagena del Chairá and San Vicente del Caguán in Caquetá, Puerto Concordia in Meta, and Yondó in Antioquia.

Buenaventura. Specifically, the PCN⁵⁴ presented a proposal to the delegations for a humanitarian route and thematic contributions for transformation of the violence in the district, including judicial and socioeconomic issues, as well as a request for information for monitoring the development of the ECSJ.⁵⁵

Likewise, the ECSJ encouraged the inclusion of communities and victims in the project Support for the Consolidation of Peace in Colombia,⁵⁶ in which young people, Pianguera women, recyclers, and local producers participated. It was also part of the project on Social and Legal Youth Participation for Local Peacebuilding in Buenaventura,⁵⁷ which is targeted toward young people linked to urban armed groups, to get them involved in peace initiatives.

In Quibdó, the ECSJ secured confirmation of the willingness of Los Mexicanos, Los Locos Yam, and RPS to continue discussions on peacebuilding in the city. In August, these armed groups committed to suspend extortion of the education, health, and construction sectors, and to eliminate extortion in the medium term.⁵⁸

In November, the ECSJ issued a communiqué inviting Los Zetas, Revolución Cabi, and the AGC to join the violence-reduction strategy. Subsequently, Los Mexicanos, Locos Yam, RPS, Revolución Cabi, and Los Zetas announced a truce until January 31, 2025, and called on the AGC to join the initiative.

The ECSJ, in coordination with the European Union, the International Center for Transitional Justice, and the Diocese of Quibdó, implemented productive initiatives with the participation of victims, indigenous people, women, and youth.

The ECSJ in Medellín and the Aburrá Valley continued to work on the development of operational protocols, communications, and humanitarian actions to reduce violence. In September, the national government delegation announced that the Senate of the Republic had approved the creation of a Permanent Commission aimed at developing a legal framework to make it easier to bring these groups to justice.

The Urban Peace Promotion Committee, which brings together more than 60 civil society organizations, signed a roadmap for citizen participation with the aim of building an agenda based on the pillars of protection of life, social dialogue, right to truth, creation of new economies, and the dismantling of the armed groups⁵⁹ in Medellín and the Aburrá Valley.

In December, the armed groups that are part of the ECSJ committed to reduce homicides, suspend extortion in 25 neighborhoods of Medellín and Bello until January 19, 2025, and contribute information to the fight against the sexual exploitation of children and adolescents and against the production, trade, and consumption of illicit drugs such as fentanyl and heroin. The ECSJ created the Team for Observation and Systematization of Peace Actions to monitor these commitments on a quarterly basis, with the support of the University of Antioquia, Pastoral Social, Fundación Paz y Reconciliación, Fundación Ideas para la Paz, and Corporación Nuevo Arcoiris.

In Buenaventura, Quibdó, and Medellín and the Aburrá Valley, the ECSJs continued to present challenges related to the absence of mechanisms for civil society participation and communication

⁵⁴ The preparation of the route was supported by the Office of the Vice President of the Republic, the Office of the Human Rights Ombudsman, the Unit for the Care and Comprehensive Reparation for Victims, the Peace and Reconciliation Foundation, and the Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights.

⁵⁵ Office of the Peace Commission Adviser (2025). Response of the Peace Commission Adviser (CCP). Progress, Achievements, and Results: Semiannual Report 38 - Periodic Report of the Secretary General to the OAS Permanent Council), pp. 5-7.

⁵⁶ European Union project implemented by the International Center for Transitional Justice and Pastoral Social.

⁵⁷ United Nations Children's Fund project.

⁵⁸ Office of the Peace Commission Adviser (2025). Response of the Peace Commission Adviser (CCP). Progress, Achievements, and Results: Semiannual Report 38 - Periodic Report of the Secretary General to the OAS Permanent Council), pp. 9-10.

⁵⁹ *Ibid.*, pp. 7-9.

strategies for the community to learn about their progress. In addition, spokespersons for the armed groups remained concerned about the definition of their legal situation, particularly with regard to the terms of their freedom.

4.5. Other initiatives, discussions, and dialogues within the framework of the Total Peace Policy

Following the issuance of Resolution 257 of 2024, which authorized the installation of a Social and Legal Discussion Forum between the national government and the AGC, the MAPP/OAS accepted the request of the parties to monitor this process.

In Antioquia, Córdoba, La Guajira, and Santander, the national government delegation convened listening sessions with municipal and departmental authorities, social leaders, and representatives of different productive sectors to identify the impacts of the actions of this armed group and receive recommendations for the development of this peace initiative. Business sectors and local authorities asked to be part of the discussions and contribute to the decision-making process. Even though the call to convene included different social sectors, some civilian authorities and communities stated that they had not been invited, and in other cases, they felt that there were no guarantees for their participation.

The Office of the President of the Republic issued Resolution 279 of 2024, in which it recognized six members of the AGC as representative members to participate in the ECSJ. The Office of the Attorney General (*Fiscalía General de la Nación*, FGN) suspended the arrest warrants for three of them, in response to which the armed group maintained the demand that this measure be extended to the three remaining individuals. This created delays at the beginning of the process.

In the case of the ACSN, the national government authorized the installation of the ECSJ, designated its delegation, and recognized seven individuals as representative members of this armed group. Due to the fact that three of them are deprived of liberty and that the armed group requested the in-person participation of its entire delegation, the ECSJ has not yet been set up.

On the other hand, during the first meeting of the peace talks between the national government and the CNEB, the armed group ratified its commitment to maintain a unilateral cease-fire while the Office of the President of the Republic issues the decree for the cessation of offensive operations. In addition, the roundtable signed an agreement to implement a pilot project for the substitution of 3,000 hectares of coca leaf in Nariño and Putumayo. One of the pending issues is the search for alternatives to resolve the legal situation of the members of the armed group.

4.6. Prison monitoring

The National Penitentiary and Prison Institute (INPEC) made progress in its human rights monitoring strategy and developed mediation plans for prevention, protection, and guarantee of the human rights of persons deprived of liberty, especially in cases involving sexual violence, excessive use of force, discrimination, and hunger strikes.⁶⁰

In the prisons of Barranquilla and Itagüí, INPEC continued to develop the special treatment program for former members of the now-nonexistent United Self-Defense Forces of Colombia being held in the Justice and Peace cellblocks. The purpose of this program is to provide tools within the framework of transitional justice for prevention of recidivism and reintegration into civilian life. It also disseminated the booklet *Cultivating Forgiveness, Reconciliation, and Resilience*, contributing to the symbolic reparation of the victims of the armed conflict.⁶¹

In national prison facilities (*Establecimientos de Reclusión del Orden Nacional*, ERON), the problems related to the provision of health services, food, legal assistance, family visits, and

⁶⁰ National Penitentiary and Prison Institute (2025). Response to request for institutional achievements, MAPP/OAS Semiannual Report, January 15, 2025, pp. 14-15.

⁶¹ *Ibid.*, pp. 23-24.

education and work opportunities had a direct impact on people who have some type of relationship with an armed group or belong to one.

Persons deprived of liberty who belong to the EMBF, AGC, and CS said that they needed to be transferred to prisons that allow them to be closer to their families. They also stated that for security reasons they need to be placed in the same space as members of their armed group and have meeting places inside the prisons to develop proposals for the improvement of their conditions of confinement and contribute to the construction of a complete peace.

The Joint Legal Commission of the peace talks between the national government and the EMBF, accompanied by the MAPP/OAS, visited the prisons of Cóbbita in Boyacá and Cúcuta in Norte de Santander to continue preparing a census to identify the persons deprived of liberty who belong to this armed group and receive information on their health care, education, and legal assistance needs.

Meanwhile, within the framework of the peace talks between the national government and the CS, the agreements reached to improve the living conditions of persons deprived of liberty who belong to this armed group allowed some of them to be transferred from other national prisons to the Pasto prison.

The MAPP/OAS, in partnership with the National Conciliation Commission, the Embassy of Sweden, and INPEC, continued to support diploma courses in “Critical Tools for Reconciliation and Peace” in prisons in Bogotá, Bucaramanga, and Cúcuta. These programs provided training to 186 prisoners, for a total of 295 prisoner participants in 2024, and were aimed at preventing violence by managing prison conflicts from a perspective of peace and reconciliation.

In addition, in the context of the Bogotá International Book Fair, the Mission led the fifth edition of the “Donating a Book Is an Act of Peace” campaign and delivered more than 600 books to the libraries of the Acacias prison in Meta and the Cúcuta prison in Norte de Santander.

5. IMPLEMENTATION OF THE FINAL PEACE AGREEMENT AND OTHER POLICIES

5.1. Comprehensive Rural Reform (RRI)

Implementation of Point 1 on Comprehensive Rural Reform in the Final Peace Agreement (*Acuerdo Final de Paz*, AFP) was strengthened with the territorialization strategy of the National Agrarian Reform and Rural Development System through the formation of Departmental and Municipal Agrarian Reform Committees in Arauca, Bolívar, Cauca, Córdoba, and Putumayo.⁶² The committees decentralize decision-making and promote an inclusive rural development model among social and productive actors from each municipality.

The national government has the challenge of coordinating new regulatory spheres such as Protection Areas for Food Production, Campesino Agri-food Territories (*Territorios Campesinos Agroalimentarios*, TECAM), and Temporary Natural Resource Reserve Zones (*Zonas de Reserva de Recursos Naturales de Carácter Temporal*). These are intended to ensure compliance with the social and ecological role of the land, as well as the functioning of the mechanisms for local participation and governance associated with each approach.

Territorially Focused Development Programs (PDETs) continue to be prioritized as a tool to stimulate the integration and economic development of the areas most affected by the armed conflict. The national government's political backing for PDETs was reflected in their inclusion in the Shock Plan to accelerate compliance with the Final Peace Agreement and in the planning strategy known as *Maquetas de Paz*, as well as in the initiative to build a national agreement.

⁶² According to the Ministry of Agriculture and Rural Development, 14 Departmental Agrarian Reform Committees and 437 Municipal Agrarian Reform Committees have been formed. Information shared in the comments sent to the MAPP/OAS by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs through official letter S-GAIOM-25-010330 of April 3, 2025.

The Agency for Territorial Renewal (*Agencia de Renovación del Territorio*, ART), together with the Ministry of the Interior and the National Planning Department, completed the review process of the Action Plans for Regional Transformation (PATR), which are essential to bridge inequality gaps in rural areas and to exercise fundamental rights. Nevertheless, communities and local authorities warned of significant lags in the implementation of the PDETs.

In Antioquia, Tolima, and Valle del Cauca, the National Land Agency established six new Campesino Reserve Zones (ZRC) with an area of 192,754 hectares.⁶³ In addition, in Arauca, the national government disseminated information about the process of establishing the department's first TECAM,⁶⁴ which is expected to promote the autonomous and secure governance of the communities. Despite these steps forward, campesino territories continue to be stigmatized, as happened in southern Córdoba and Bajo Cauca where an armed group threatened and forcibly displaced campesino leaders promoting the establishment of ZRCs.

Progress was made with the multipurpose cadastre in Antioquia, Arauca, and Cauca, facilitating the beginning of efforts to formalize land titles to the benefit of landless or land-deficient campesino communities. In addition, the intercultural and interethnic dialogue being carried out through the Land Roundtable of northern Cauca allowed the national government to deliver 1,500 hectares to Afro-descendent, indigenous, and campesino communities in 13 of the region's municipalities.⁶⁵

In Córdoba, the Unit for the Care and Comprehensive Reparation of Victims (UARIV) turned over 7,916 hectares⁶⁶ to associations of victims and campesina women, in the context of the strategy of the Reparation Fund for Victims to recover lands that were being exploited by illegal actors. The strategy aims to address the improper administration of resources for comprehensive reparation.

In addition, the Land Restitution Unit (URT),⁶⁷ taking a human security approach, adjusted its protocols on mobility and entry into territories for proceedings, which allowed it to expand its territorial deployment to areas where the security situation was not promising. To this end, it diversified the criteria for analysis and supplemented the assessments of the security forces with information from international cooperation agencies and communities.

The control exercised by the armed groups included the imposition of charges for the sale and lease of real estate, the dispossession of land used for legal and illegal economic activities, as well as the determination of the type and quantity of agricultural products to be produced.

In Bolívar, Caquetá, Guaviare, and Meta, armed groups prevented the entry of public servants doing RRI-related work. Restrictions on access to certain areas by armed groups participating in peace talks with the national government, combined with a coerced coexistence and citizen participation, hinder the execution of territorial transformation and jeopardize confidence in the peace processes.

5.2. Strategies for the reduction of illicit crops and dynamics of drug-related activity

In October, the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime published the report *Monitoring of Territories with Presence of Coca Cultivation*, which indicated that in 2023 Colombia had 252,572 hectares planted, an increase of 9.8% over 2022. The report indicated that there continued

⁶³ Information from the Ministry of Agriculture and Rural Development shared in the comments sent to the MAPP/OAS by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs through official letter S-GAIOM-25-010330 of April 3, 2025.

⁶⁴ National Land Agency (2024). "Here, Agrarian Reform advances to the extent that the campesinos do not let go": Felipe Harman, during the Arauca Mission. Available at: <https://lc.cx/ZbgUJL>

⁶⁵ Ministry of the Interior (2024). "National government presented progress at the peace talks in Norte del Cauca." Available at: <https://lc.cx/Qc93YD>

⁶⁶ Information from the National Land Agency shared bilaterally with the MAPP/OAS, within the framework of the relationship between the institutions.

⁶⁷ During the period, the Director and the Secretary General of the URT were victims of attacks on their physical integrity and their property, evidence that the risks continue for those who lead the public land restitution policy.

to be 15 productive enclaves,⁶⁸ and although it did not give evidence of an expansion of crops to new regions, it did warn about the growth of coca leaf concentration, with Nariño, Putumayo, Norte de Santander, Cauca, and Antioquia being the affected areas. It also noted that potential cocaine production grew by 53.2% that year, from 1,738 to 2,664 metric tons.

The national government managed to manually eradicate 9,403 hectares of coca leaf crops, approaching the goal of 10,000 hectares established by the Ministry of National Defense. Between July and December,⁶⁹ it eradicated 7,220 hectares, a 41.1% reduction⁷⁰ compared with the same period in 2023. The amount of cocaine hydrochloride seized during the second half of 2024 was 442 tons for a total of 883 tons for the year,⁷¹ an increase of 4.2%⁷² over the same period in 2023.

The Office of the President of the Republic issued Directive 8 of 2024, in which it instructed national government institutions to coordinate their actions for the substitution of illicit crops within the framework of the National Drug Policy 2023-2033. This order created an Operational Committee⁷³ responsible for coordinating projects and strategies for crop substitution and the transition from illicit to licit economies. This will allow the Directorate for the Substitution of Illicit Crops (DSCI) to formulate territorially focused agreements that include communities in the design, execution, and monitoring.

The DSCI made progress in complying with the agreements established under the National Program for the Substitution of Illicit Crops through the renegotiation of short-cycle and long-cycle productive projects and the development of productive reconversion and territorial transformation projects. To carry out these projects, the Directorate opened calls for proposals to create a bank of local suppliers who will sell the inputs, thus avoiding the intermediation of third parties.

While beneficiaries acknowledged that the National Program for the Substitution of Illicit Crops had made progress and changes, they maintained that they are cautious and mistrustful due to noncompliance and changes in the terms of implementation in previous years. These perceptions represent challenges for the institutions responsible for raising awareness about the new substitution program, which continued to move toward its territorial focus.

In December, in the context of the peace talks between the national government and the CNEB, an agreement was signed to implement a pilot project for the substitution of 3,000 hectares of coca leaf in Nariño and Putumayo. Its design and execution will be a challenge for the institutions involved in terms of coordinating supply and creating security conditions to prevent harmful impacts on the civilian population.

The stagnation and lower prices that had been seen for cocaine base shifted to a new trend marked by increased purchases and sales and higher value. In regions of Antioquia, Cauca,

⁶⁸ A productive enclave is considered to be a territory that in the last five years has had a highly significant concentration of coca crops and that the situation has continued for more than four years. According to the report, the 15 productive enclaves are: Catatumbo, Valdivia-Tarazá-Cáceres, San Pablo-Taracué, Timba-Jamundí-Buenos Aires, El Naya, Timbiquí-Saija, Argelia-El Tambo, El Charco-Olaya Herrera, El Charco-El Turbio, Policarpa-Patía, Roberto Payán-Isagualpi, Frontera Tumaco, Telembí-Cristal, Orito-Vides, and Frontera Putumayo. Taken from: Ministry of Justice and Law (2024). Monitoring of Territories with Presence of Coca Crops 2023, pp. 5-6. Available at: <https://lc.cx/pvc3Ls>

⁶⁹ In Putumayo (5,664 hectares), Antioquia (162 hectares), Bolívar (97 hectares), Boyacá (57 hectares), Santander (48 hectares), and Nariño (22 hectares). Taken from Ministry of Justice and Law (2025). Colombian Drug Information System. Available at: <https://lc.cx/aDO4ym>

⁷⁰ The number of hectares of coca leaf eradicated manually in the second half of 2023 was 12,270. Taken from the Ministry of National Defense (2024). Follow-up on security indicators and operational results. December 2024, p. 43.

⁷¹ Ministry of National Defense (2024). Follow-up on security indicators and operational results. December 2024, p. 44.

⁷² The amount of cocaine hydrochloride seized during the second half of 2023 was 424 tons. Taken from Ministry of National Defense (2024). Follow-up on security indicators and operational results. December 2024, p. 44.

⁷³ The committee comprises the Ministries of Justice and Law, Agriculture and Rural Development, Environment and Sustainable Development, Interior, and Mines, as well as the National Planning Department and the Agency for Territorial Renewal. Taken from Office of the President of the Republic (2024). Presidential Directive 08. Available at: <https://lc.cx/myakOZ>

Córdoba, Nariño, Norte de Santander, and Valle del Cauca, the prices of cocaine base increased to between COP2.7 million and COP3 million (approximately US\$650 to US\$730),⁷⁴ a figure close to the values before 2022, when a price reduction began to be identified.

This incipient trend reversal had to do with sustained demand by buyers and the reactivation of trade networks. In addition, the presence of one or more armed groups, the different levels of control they exercised in the territories, as well as changes in their relationships were all factors that altered the dynamics of the market for cocaine base.

5.3. Comprehensive reparation of victims

The Unit for the Care and Comprehensive Reparation of Victims (UARIV) made progress in guarantees for participation through a campaign called “Victims’ Voices: National call for life and peace” [*Voces de las Víctimas: llamado nacional por la vida y por la paz*], which seeks a resumption of talks and compliance with the peace agreements with the various armed groups.⁷⁵

Law 2421 of 2024 amended the Victims and Land Restitution Act and represented a step forward in terms of broadening the concept of victim for purposes of recognition and the guarantee and protection of rights. This allowed for coordination among the institutions created by the Comprehensive System of Truth, Justice, Reparation, and Non-Repetition, including the victims accredited by the Special Jurisdiction for Peace and those recognized by the Unit for the Search for Missing Persons (UBPD).

In Antioquia, Arauca, Bolívar, Caquetá, Casanare, Cauca, Chocó, Córdoba, La Guajira, Nariño, Putumayo, and Valle del Cauca, humanitarian emergencies arising from the armed conflict exceeded the capacity of the territorial entities as first responders. As a result, the UARIV provided subsidiary assistance of an event-response nature, covering 35 cases of confinement, 26 mass forced displacements, and one terrorist act. The responses to the 62 emergencies benefited 46,636 people.⁷⁶

Despite these efforts, the UARIV must strengthen its leadership in prevention and emergency response so that the institution can provide more effective and relevant services. In this regard, the measures delivered must incorporate differential approaches, particularly the gender approach, as some victims stated that the kits delivered did not meet their diverse needs.

Additionally, the UARIV ordered the payment of 164,552 individual reparations to 164,051 victims, a 13% increase in the number of victims compensated compared to the first half of 2024.⁷⁷ In the case of the 769 ethnic groups that are Subjects of Collective Reparation (SRC), the UARIV made progress in preparing 78 identification cards and 74 damage descriptions, closing 120 enrollments, and notarizing 51 Comprehensive Collective Reparation Plans, as well as in compensating eight SRCs in Cauca, Chocó, Nariño, and Risaralda.⁷⁸

In the context of collective reparation measures for Community Action Organizations, the National Community Security Roundtable held its second session, reviewed its internal regulations, and held the first meeting of the National Pact for Community Human Rights. In

⁷⁴ This is in contrast to the first half of 2024, in which prices for cocaine base ranged between COP1.4 million and COP2.2 (approximately US\$340 to US\$530). This calculation uses an exchange rate of US\$1=COP4,100) as a reference value.

⁷⁵ Unit for the Care and Comprehensive Reparation of Victims (2025). Response to the request for accomplishments for the 38th Semiannual Report of the Secretary General to the Permanent Council of the OAS, covering July 1 to December 31, 2024, pp. 2-3.

⁷⁶ *Ibid.*, p. 13.

⁷⁷ *Ibid.*, p. 15.

⁷⁸ *Ibid.*, p. 4.

addition, the Ministry of the Interior and the governments of Cesar, Nariño, and Valle del Cauca installed Departmental Community Security Roundtables.

There continued to be operational problems related to convening the roundtables, complying with timetables, and following up on the commitments made. Additionally, the limited scope of the roundtables with their departmental jurisdiction represents a challenge to comprehensively address risk situations that transcend territorial boundaries, in a context of persistent violence and harmful impacts shared by different regions.

5.4. Search for missing persons

In 2024, the Unit for the Search for Missing Persons located and recovered 1,239 bodies⁷⁹ and found 141 people alive. Also, pursuant to the precautionary measures of the Special Jurisdiction for Peace,⁸⁰ its comprehensive forensic intervention enabled the recovery of bodies in the case of La Escombrera in Medellín.

For its part, the National Search System (SNB) made progress in developing the strategic plan for the territorialization of its work, as well as in defining guidelines for communications, citizen participation, and instruction. Additionally, it took steps to comply with the JEP precautionary measures in relation to preventive forensic intervention in infrastructure projects and the creation of a technical roundtable for the national strategy on the collection of biological samples in bulk to expedite data collection for searches, among other actions.⁸¹

The universe of victims of disappearance rose to 124,734 people, of whom 13,904 were reported missing in the second half of 2024.⁸² In this context, the SNB began to formulate the Comprehensive Public Policy for Care, Prevention, Search, and Identification of Persons Reported Missing due to the Armed Conflict, given the need to respond to cases that occurred after December 1, 2016, over which the UBPD lacks jurisdiction.

The roadmap for this policy reached the assessment and formulation phase. The SNB implemented mechanisms for citizen participation such as a website button, telephone surveys, working sessions with focus groups, and territorial meetings in which 1,104 people participated, most of them women.⁸³ With this information, the SNB put together the first version of the technical and regulatory assessment of the policy, highlighting the critical points and solution alternatives that will determine the lines and objectives of the policy.

On the occasion of the enactment of Law 2364 of 2024, which recognizes the role of the women who search for the missing, the SNB established methodologies for working and coordinating with the Ministry of the Interior, the Ministry of Equality and Equity, the Office of the Human Rights Ombudsman, and the National Planning Department. In Apartadó, Florencia, Puerto Asís, San José del Guaviare, and Yopal, the SNB held territorial meetings so that these women searchers could contribute to the formulation of the comprehensive public policy.

Meanwhile, the Roundtable for the Joint Construction of Territorial Peace in Nariño between the national government and the CS signed Agreement No. 2 on guarantees related to the search for missing persons. The agreement includes the coordination of search activities in the territory, the creation of a search team made up of 10 people, and the armed group's commitment against forced disappearance.

⁷⁹ Between 2018 and 2024, the UBPD recovered a total of 2,490 bodies. Information from the Peace Agreement Implementation Unit shared in the comments submitted to the MAPP/OAS by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs through official letter S-GAIOM-25-010330 of April 3, 2025.

⁸⁰ Unit for the Search for Missing Persons (2025). Response to File #UBPD-2-2024-011614, pp. 4 and 22.

⁸¹ Ministry of Justice and Law (2025). Request for Institutional Achievements, MAPP/OAS Semiannual Report, pp. 4 and 6.

⁸² Unit for the Search for Missing Persons (2025). Response to File #UBPD-2-2024-011614, p. 22.

⁸³ *Ibid.*, p.11.

The Social and Legal Discussion Forum in Buenaventura was the scene of educational activities on forced disappearance, geared toward Los Shottas and Los Espartanos, and on the mechanisms to contribute to Phase II of the search plan for the San Antonio estuary as part of the JEP precautionary measure.

The Office of the President of the Republic, through Resolution 453 of 2024, designated 18 former members of the now-nonexistent United Self-Defense Forces of Colombia as peace promoters who could contribute to the search for missing persons and reparations to victims. The MAPP/OAS, in accordance with its mandate, accepted the invitation to monitor this initiative.

5.5. Transitional Justice⁸⁴

Nearly 20 years after the enactment of Law 975 of 2005,⁸⁵ the special criminal proceeding under the Justice and Peace Law has revealed important aspects of the truth about the armed conflict in Colombia, including the scale of the harm inflicted on the civilian population and the judicial responsibility of economic and political actors. The Justice and Peace Chambers (*Salas de Justicia y Paz*) have prosecuted 75,530 victimizing acts and have recognized 56,957 victims by means of 80 final judgments.⁸⁶

Building on this progress, the Special Jurisdiction for Peace and the Justice and Peace system have worked in coordination, focusing on clarifying the facts and protecting the rights of victims. For example, they have held technical roundtables for the exchange of information on macro-criminal patterns and routes for identification of perpetrators. Specifically, the JEP has used the judgments handed down in the context of the Justice and Peace system as input for studying requests for justice.⁸⁷

Despite the progress made, challenges remain to achieve the satisfaction of victims' rights, overcome impunity for crimes committed in the context of the armed conflict, and guarantee due process.⁸⁸ One of these challenges is the time it has taken to resolve the cases, due to the adoption of procedural methods typical of the ordinary justice system for the prosecution of those who are most responsible, hampering the comprehensive reparation of the victims.

It is also key to ensure the financing of the UARIV Reparation Fund for Victims in order to comply with the payment of compensation, recognized and still to be recognized through judgments. Another challenge is to consolidate effective coordination between the different jurisdictions and entities in charge of transitional justice and comprehensive reparations for victims.⁸⁹

Overcoming these challenges will entail identifying and adjusting procedural and budgetary aspects, seeking a balance between processing time, victims' rights, the legal certainty of applicants and those who appear before the courts, and institutional capacity.

6. ENVIRONMENTAL PEACE

⁸⁴ In accordance with its mandate, the Mission monitors, supports, and provides technical assistance for the creation and implementation of transitional justice processes and mechanisms.

⁸⁵ The Justice and Peace Chambers became fully operational in 2012.

⁸⁶ Information shared by the Circuit Criminal Court of Enforcement of Judgment for the Justice and Peace Chambers of the National Territory as of January 2025.

⁸⁷ Special Jurisdiction for Peace (2025). "Response to your communication," p. 7.

⁸⁸ For example, Legislative Bill 388 of 2025 proposes reforms to speed up proceedings under the Justice and Peace Law, taking into account principles of the American Convention on Human Rights such as reasonable time for the completion of judicial proceedings.

⁸⁹ Various national and international judicial bodies issue decisions aimed at guaranteeing the rights of the victims of the armed conflict—Justice and Peace, the Special Jurisdiction for Peace, the Land Restitution specialty, the Council of State, the Constitutional Court, and the Inter-American Court of Human Rights—which raises the need for greater institutional coordination to avoid duplication, cost overruns, and gaps in implementation. Law 2421 of 2024 and Decree 3011 of 2013 have created forums for inter-institutional coordination; the challenge is to ensure that these existing mechanisms work effectively.

The GS/OAS, through the MAPP/OAS and the Assistant Secretary General's Office, accompanied the Conference of the Parties to the Convention on Biological Diversity (COP16), which took place in Cali, Valle del Cauca, and participated in knowledge-sharing forums, reaffirming that peace in Colombia is a matter of global interest and an environmental and climate imperative for the entire planet. Political and financial support for peace in Colombia represents a unique opportunity to halt and reverse the loss of biodiversity in strategic ecosystems and take action against climate change.

The national government, in fulfillment of its obligations as a state party to the Convention, presented its Biodiversity Action Plan 2030⁹⁰ in which it recognizes the relationship between armed conflict, illegal networks, and biodiversity loss. The Action Plan includes the promotion of the agroforestry economy and the implementation of the Final Peace Agreement, as well as steps to prevent nature from continuing to represent a pressure factor for armed groups in the ongoing peace talks.

COP16 recognized the valuable role played by indigenous, Afro-descendent, and campesino communities in the conservation of biodiversity; at the same time, it warned that they are victims of extraordinary risk for carrying out activities in defense of their territories and due to the precarious implementation of the prevention and protection measures to which the Colombian state committed itself under the Escazú Agreement.

The incorporation of environmental issues in the peace talks identified the need for regulatory changes to address the tension between environmental protection and the economic development of communities living in Forest Reserve Zones and National Natural Parks. An update of the types of protection in Forest Reserve Zones, the regularization of the carbon bond market, and the draft legislation on traceability of deforestation-free livestock production are some of the initiatives that would facilitate the incorporation of an environmental sustainability approach in the rural development of the territories most affected by the armed conflict.

In Bajo Cauca, the Ministry of Mines and Energy created the first Agro-mining District to formalize mining activities, protect ecosystems, and generate an economy based on food production that discourages communities' dependence on extractive activities. The limited enforcement of environmental and mining regulations is conducive to the proliferation of illicit economies, so this concept represents an opportunity that can be replicated in other parts of the country where the extraction of mineral deposits is also associated with the presence of armed groups.

The implementation of judicial operations against deforestation and illegal roads in the northern part of the Serranía de Chiribiquete National Park highlighted the need for regulatory changes to advance agreements between environmental institutions and communities to reduce deforestation in the national park. After the operations, the armed groups increased restrictions to entry for environmental officials and programs to protected areas in Caquetá, Guaviare, Meta, and Putumayo.

Illegal mining continued to contaminate water sources and lead to deforestation in Caquetá, Cauca, and Valle del Cauca, as well as in the regions of Bajo Cauca and northeastern Antioquia, southern Bolívar, San Juan and Atrato, southern Córdoba, Telembí, and Bajo Putumayo.

In these territories, the authorities and communities noted an increase in the entry and use of backhoes, which contaminated and diverted riverbeds, causing soil erosion and loss of biodiversity. This has encouraged some families to depend on extractive activities over agriculture and fishing to ensure their food security.

Bodies of water continued to be affected by oil spills due to attacks by the armed groups on oil infrastructure in Arauca, Norte de Santander, and Putumayo, as well as by the discharge of

⁹⁰ Ministry of Environment and Sustainable Development (2024). Biodiversity Action Plan for Colombia to 2030. Available at: <https://lc.cx/dlBlnT>

chemicals used in the processing of cocaine base in Antioquia, Caquetá, Cauca, Córdoba, Nariño, and Putumayo.

In the Catatumbo Barí, Serranía de Chiribiquete, Farallones de Cali, Nudo de Paramillo, La Paya, and Sierra de La Macarena National Parks, deforestation continued to be carried out for the operation of licit and illicit economies and the opening of illegal roads. Armed groups continued to impose restrictions on the use and care of natural resources in Caquetá, Chocó, Guaviare, Meta, Nariño, and Norte de Santander.⁹¹

Social leaders who worked in defense of the environment were victims of homicides, threats, and extortion by the armed groups, especially those who reported illegal mining, the contamination of water sources, and the exploitation of timber resources.

7. PARTICIPATION AND CAPACITY BUILDING FOR SOCIAL DIALOGUE

Colombian institutions have placed a priority on addressing social conflicts in order to make progress in peacebuilding. Making this commitment a reality will require coordination and complementarity between the national, departmental, and municipal levels; it will also require defining legal tools and strengthening capacities for dialogue and the construction of sustainable consensus among diverse sectors for the transformation of social conflicts, under the premise of *talk so as to agree, agree so as to comply, comply so as to transform*.

The Attorney General's Office issued Directive 0001 of 2024⁹² on the recognition, guarantee, and protection of the fundamental right to peaceful social protest enshrined in the Constitution. Among other things, the directive established that no one may be investigated or prosecuted for calling for or exercising the right to protest within the limits of the legal framework, and stated that, as a general rule, public security forces should not use violent means to break up protests.

Legal actions against the extraction of mineral deposits and the increase in the price of diesel fuel were the basis for some of the social protests that limited the free movement of goods and people. The authorities and protesters resolved these mobilizations in a peaceful and negotiated manner.

The reactivation of some of the social dialogue opportunities responded to the need to address commitments taken on by previous administrations after protests and strikes in the territories. For example, the Ministry of the Interior revitalized the dialogue roundtable to follow up on the Panoya agreements in the cordillera of Nariño, after three years without concrete results and following the communities' announcement about the resumption of protests. However, the availability of comprehensive institutional services was limited by the absence of some ministries and government agencies that had been convened, as well as by the scant prior coordination and the lack of information on follow-up to the agreed actions.

In this context, the MAPP/OAS implemented processes to strengthen capacity in social dialogue, conflict transformation, strategy design, and the use of analytical tools. These training exercises were geared toward the social dialogue teams at the Ministry of Environment and Sustainable Development, the Ministry of Agriculture and Rural Development, the Rural Development Agency, and the National Land Agency. The Mission recognizes their political will and commitment to strengthen their capacities for the implementation of the Comprehensive Rural Reform.

Teams from local Ombudsman's Offices (*Personerías*), Government Secretariats, Police Inspectorates, and the Office of the Human Rights Ombudsman (*Defensoría del Pueblo*) also took part in these processes implemented by the MAPP/OAS. In particular, regional officials from ECOPETROL reinforced their skills and competencies to transform social conflicts related to

⁹¹ Restrictions include the number of hectares allowed for logging, the location and acreage of agricultural crops, prohibitions on hunting wild animals or fishing, among others.

⁹² Office of the Attorney General (2024). Directive 0001 of 2024. Available at: <https://lc.cx/8cvEPo>

natural resource extractive activities. Ongoing capacity building and the use of trained personnel would promote improvements in relations between state entities and civil society.

8. WOMEN, PEACE, AND SECURITY AGENDA

After 24 years of advocacy by women's organizations and platforms and a participatory, extensive, and diverse process of construction, the Vice Ministry of Women began implementation of the seven thematic lines⁹³ of the National Action Plan of Resolution 1325 (PAN 1325). The plan established 11 results, 105 actions with commitments for 33 entities,⁹⁴ and a follow-up mechanism comprising the Ministry of Equality and Equity, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, the Ministry of the Interior, the Ministry of Defense, civil society, and the international community.

The implementation of PAN 1325 is an opportunity to strengthen the capacities of women delegates in the peace talks, as well as women representing the security forces in peace processes. The weak coordination between PAN 1325 and the Total Peace Policy hinders the incorporation of the gender and peace agenda into the protocols, agreements, and territorial transformation plans derived from the peace talks and the discussion forums on social and legal issues.

The Inter-American Commission of Women of the Organization of American States, the MAPP/OAS, and the Vice Ministry of Women held the "Cristina Bautista Taquinas" Course for Female Candidates to Regular Elections and Indigenous Peoples' Governments. This experience, in which the Mission actively participated, was an achievement in terms of intersectionality and capacity building for the participation and political advocacy of indigenous women from different countries of the Americas.⁹⁵

In July, the Action Plan 2024-2026 of the Comprehensive Program of Guarantees for Women Leaders and Human Rights Defenders was presented. The Human Rights Directorate of the Ministry of the Interior made progress in its territorialization process, with the participation of more than 800 women in 16 departments.⁹⁶ In some of these territories, the Ministry and local authorities formulated Territorial Action Plans to guide coordination among institutions and the implementation of concrete actions by mayors' and governors' offices.

These steps forward are evidence of the national government's efforts to promote actions with gender-differentiated measures within the framework of human security. However, the challenge of prevention and protection of women leaders and their families continues, given the escalation in the number of harmful impacts to them due to the armed conflict. The protection of women leaders includes providing guarantees regarding their labor rights, access to land, education, and economic autonomy, among other areas.

9. SITUATIONS IN BORDER AREAS

In border areas, Colombian and migrant populations were victims of homicides, kidnappings, human trafficking, migrant smuggling, sexual violence, forced disappearance, threats, imposition of payments, and enlistment by the armed groups.

⁹³ The thematic lines of PAN 1325 are as follows: women guardians of peace; health and well-being for women and girls in their diversity; life free of violence against women; access to justice for women and girl victims; protection of the territory from the actions of illegal armed groups and extractive industries that generate violence; economic autonomy of women; and human mobility of displaced women, refugees, and migrants.

⁹⁴ Republic of Colombia (2024). First National Action Plan: Women, Peace, and Security, United Nations Security Council Resolution 1325, p. 5. Available at: https://lc.cx/Stje_0

⁹⁵ Indigenous women leaders from Argentina, Bolivia, Chile, Costa Rica, Ecuador, Guatemala, Mexico, Panama, Paraguay, Peru, and Venezuela participated in the training process.

⁹⁶ In the departments of Antioquia, Arauca, Atlántico, Caquetá, Cauca, Chocó, Bolívar, Córdoba, La Guajira, Magdalena, Meta, Nariño, Norte de Santander, Putumayo, Sucre, and Valle del Cauca.

On the border with Panama, migrants continued to move by land and sea, trying to reach the United States. Despite the different measures implemented by the states, in Acandí and Juradó in Chocó, the Colombian population perceived a decrease in the flow of migrants by land; this was in contrast to the dynamics in Buenaventura in Valle del Cauca, where authorities and communities indicated that there had been an upward trend in irregular transit to the same destination.

Armed groups continued to clash with each other on Colombia's border with Venezuela, boosting illicit economies and avoiding institutional control. Along the border areas of Norte de Santander in particular, they continued to smuggle contraband and steal hydrocarbons for processing cocaine base. Likewise, the armed groups abandoned dead bodies and tightened controls over foreigners transiting through this border zone.

On the Colombia-Ecuador border, clashes continued between the armed groups that control migrant smuggling, contraband, illegal mining, and drug-related activities. In Nariño and Putumayo, the armed groups promoted coca leaf cultivation along the border and took people across the border to Peru to perform forced labor if they were branded as having failed to make the payments imposed on them. Particularly in the Tumaco border area in Nariño, contamination from antipersonnel mines continued, which hampered the mobility of binational ethnic communities.

10. RECOMMENDATIONS

10.1 To the Office of the Peace Commission Adviser

In the framework of peace initiatives, discussions, and dialogues

- 10.1.1 Influence the adoption of commitments by the armed groups related to the identification of sites of forensic interest and the demarcation of humanitarian corridors for the search for persons reported as missing, as an act of peace.
- 10.1.2 Review procedures for coordinating among institutions to strengthen the implementation and follow-up of the agreements reached, taking into account the definition of roles and responsibilities of the different national, regional, and local entities, as well as the budget allocation and availability of resources.
- 10.1.3 Design, in coordination with the Ministry of Equality and Equity, an advocacy and pedagogical methodology for incorporating the guidelines of the 2000 National Action Plan of Resolution 1325 in the protocols and agreements generated by the delegations.
- 10.1.4 With the armed groups that maintain an active, bilateral cease-fire, sign explicit commitments of respect and noninterference in the access of officials and in the implementation of humanitarian and territorial transformation programs for peace. This would mitigate the risks faced by entities such as the Land Restitution Unit, the Unit for the Search for Missing Persons, the National Land Agency, the Unit for the Care and Comprehensive Reparation of Victims, as well as environmental programs and other initiatives, whose officials have been victims of restrictions by armed groups on access to the territories.
- 10.1.5 Advocate for compliance with the agreement and the protocol on citizen participation signed by the parties to the peace talks between the national government and the Blocs and Front High Command, in order to provide guarantees for civil society's autonomous and safe participation, as well as assess their intervention in decision-making and in the follow-up to commitments.
- 10.1.6 Prioritize the installation of local offices of the Oversight, Monitoring, and Verification Mechanism of the bilateral cease-fire between the national government and the Blocs and

Front High Command in Cartagena del Chairá and San Vicente del Caguán in Caquetá, Puerto Concordia in Meta, and Yondó in Antioquia, providing the logistical conditions and security guarantees for them to be able to operate.

- 10.1.7 Coordinate with the delegations from the national government and the Blocs and Front High Command to teach civil society and local authorities about the bilateral cease-fire, with an emphasis on the functioning of the Oversight, Monitoring, and Verification Mechanism.
- 10.1.8 Design a strategy for accepting and systematizing proposals from civil society and local institutions in preparation for an eventual peace process between the national government and the Gaitanista Self-Defense Forces of Colombia, considering categories such as territorial transformation, citizen participation, and guarantee of victims' rights, among others.
- 10.1.9 Promote the approval of protocols for the operation, communications, and civil society participation in the Social and Legal Discussion Forums of Buenaventura, Quibdó, and Medellín and the Aburrá Valley.

To the Decontaminate Colombia team specifically

- 10.1.10 Continue strengthening Mine Risk Education and psychological care in territories that have lost the demarcation of dangerous areas and where communities have engaged in unsafe behavior, especially in the departments of Arauca, Nariño, Putumayo, and Valle del Cauca and in the regions of Urabá, southern Bolívar, southern Cauca, southern Córdoba, and Catatumbo.
- 10.1.11 Redouble efforts to implement the prevention measures of the policy regarding Comprehensive Action against Antipersonnel Mines in the Pacific coast and cordillera areas of Nariño and in Baudó in Chocó, given the risk of the civilian population returning to lands with abandoned illicit crops and contaminated by antipersonnel mines.

10.2 To the Ministry of the Interior

- 10.2.1 Make the necessary modifications so that the Community Security Roundtables can address shared problems between departments and add capacity for risk mitigation in the exercise of community action.
- 10.2.2 Accelerate the consolidation of the expanded participation forums under the Comprehensive Program of Guarantees for Women Leaders and Human Rights Defenders in the territories where information about this program and its action plan has not been disseminated.
- 10.2.3 Continue strengthening the dialogue and negotiation skills of teams of public servants who participate in roundtables for the transformation of social conflicts.
- 10.2.4 Strengthen tools for monitoring agreements reached through social dialogue, considering the exchange of information with other entities and facilitating access and accountability to local authorities, communities, other stakeholders, and third parties.

10.3 To the Ministry of National Defense

Based on the restructuring of the military forces, maintain periodic evaluations regarding the effectiveness and efficiency of the various units in accordance with international humanitarian law, prioritizing the protection of the civilian population and considering the changes in the

dynamics of confrontation with, and disputes among, the armed groups, as well as the operational and logistical needs of the military forces.

10.4 To the Ministry of Justice and Law

Provide opportunities for exchange, analysis, and reflection with the Special Jurisdiction for Peace, the Justice and Peace Chambers, the Office of the Attorney General, the Office of the Inspector General, and the Office of the Human Rights Ombudsman, among others, so that, based on their area of competence, they can identify the procedural and budgetary changes needed to satisfy the rights of the victims.

10.5 To the Ministry of Agriculture and Rural Development

Design a strategy for raising awareness about the new approaches to land use planning applicable in each region, geared toward local authorities, social platforms, and productive sectors to promote compliance with the social and ecological role of the land, as well as the functioning of the monitoring, participation, and local governance mechanisms associated with each approach.

10.6 To the Ministry of Environment and Sustainable Development

Within the framework of the implementation of the Escazú Agreement,

- 10.6.1 Coordinate with the relevant entities the adoption of timely measures to prevent, investigate, and punish harms to environmental leaders related to the armed conflict, taking advantage of forums such as the Human Rights Network for Environmental Defenders of the Amazon.
- 10.6.2 Design a decentralized citizen participation mechanism that allows environmental leaders and indigenous, Afro-descendent, and campesino communities to strengthen their environmental governance and participate in environmental monitoring and decision-making processes. In this sense, it is advisable to explore the possibility of coordinating with existing local participation venues such as the Municipal Agrarian Reform Committees.

10.7 To the Office of the Presidential Adviser for Human Rights and International Humanitarian Law

Within the framework of the Intersectoral Commission for the Prevention of Recruitment, Use, Abuse, and Sexual Violence against Children and Adolescents,

- 10.7.1 Continue strengthening care for minors who are victims or are at risk of forced recruitment, use, abuse, and sexual violence, by providing technical assistance, budget allocation, and capacity building of Immediate Response Teams.
- 10.7.2 In coordination with the Ministry of National Education and the certified Secretariats of Education, develop educational models adapted to the risks of the armed conflict, based on the Safe Schools strategy, in the regions of Bajo Cauca, northeastern and northern Antioquia, Sarare in Arauca, southern Bolívar, northern Cauca, Catatumbo, northern Caquetá, lower Putumayo, southern Córdoba, and southern Meta, as well as in the municipalities of Juradó and Quibdó in Chocó and Piamonte in Cauca.

10.8 To the Unit for the Care and Comprehensive Reparation of Victims

- 10.8.1 In responding to humanitarian emergencies, strengthen differential approaches, especially the gender approach, in providing immediate subsidiary aid and care, so that the institutional services are relevant to the needs of diverse populations.

10.8.2 In coordination with the National Land Agency and the Public Prosecutor's Office, accelerate the strategy for recovering assets from the Victims Reparation Fund that are being used by illegal actors, including the modification of the protocols for receiving and managing Fund properties, the incorporation of citizen oversight and control mechanisms, and the promotion of the respective investigations and sanctions.

10.9 To the Unit for the Search for Missing Persons

In coordination with the Ministry of Justice and Law, strengthen the mechanism by which entities and communities can provide feedback to the Comprehensive Public Policy for Care, Prevention, Search, and Identification of Persons Reported Missing due to the Armed Conflict, ensuring broad and diverse participation.

10.10 To the Directorate for the Substitution of Illicit Crops

Strengthen the formulation of the new illicit crop substitution program through ongoing evaluation of its processes with a territorial focus, considering the following variables: i) the upward trends in the concentration of these crops, according to the report Monitoring of Territories with Presence of Coca Crops 2023; and ii) the impact of the progress and adjustments to the Comprehensive National Program for the Substitution of Illicit Crops.

10.11 To the National Penitentiary and Prison Institute

Study the feasibility of placing in specific cellblocks prisoners who state that they belong to the same armed group, facilitating the possibility that they can meet to develop proposals that would contribute to the Total Peace Policy.

LIST OF ACRONYMS AND ABBREVIATIONS USED IN THE REPORT

ACSN - *Autodefensas Conquistadores de la Sierra Nevada* (Conquering Self-Defense Forces of the Sierra Nevada).

AETCR - *Antiguo Espacio Territorial de Capacitación y Reincorporación* (Former Territorial Training and Reintegration Area).

AFP - *Acuerdo Final de Paz* (Final Peace Agreement).

AGC - *Autodefensas Gaitanistas de Colombia* (Gaitanista Self-Defense Forces of Colombia).

AICMA - *Acción Integral Contra Minas Antipersonal* (Comprehensive Action against Antipersonnel Mines).

AUN - *Autodefensas Unidas de Nariño* (United Self-Defense Forces of Nariño).

CFBLT - *Cese al Fuego Bilateral de Carácter Local y Temporal* (Local and Temporary Bilateral Cease-fire).

CFBT - *Cese al Fuego Bilateral y Temporal con Respeto a la Población Civil* (Bilateral and Temporary Cease-fire with Respect for the Civilian Population).

CIPRUNNA - *Comisión Intersectorial para la Prevención del Reclutamiento, el Uso, la Utilización y la Violencia Sexual contra Niños, Niñas y Adolescentes* (Intersectoral Commission for the Prevention of Recruitment, Use, Abuse, and Sexual Violence against Children and Adolescents).

CNEB - *Coordinadora Nacional Ejército Bolivariano* (National Coordinator of the Bolivarian Army).

COP - Colombian pesos.

COP16 - Conference of the Parties to the Convention on Biological Diversity.

CS - *Comuneros del Sur*.

ECSJ – *Espacios de Conversación Sociojurídica* (Social and Legal Discussion Forums).

EMBF – *Estado Mayor de los Bloques Comandante Jorge Suárez Briceño, Magdalena Medio Comandante Gentil Duarte y Frente Comandante Raúl Reyes* (High Command of the Comandante Jorge Suárez Briceño Bloc, the Magdalena Medio Comandante Gentil Duarte Bloc, and the Comandante Raúl Reyes Front).

EMC - *Estado Mayor Central de las FARC-EP* (Central High Command of the FARC-EP).

ELN - *Ejército de Liberación Nacional* (National Liberation Army).

FGN - *Fiscalía General de la Nación* (Office of the Attorney General).

GA – *Grupos armados* (armed groups).

GS/OAS - General Secretariat of the Organization of American States.

IED - Improvised explosive devices.

INPEC - *Instituto Nacional Penitenciario y Carcelario* (National Penitentiary and Prison Institute).

JEP - *Jurisdicción Especial para la Paz* (Special Jurisdiction for Peace).

MAPP/OAS - Organization of American States Mission to Support the Peace Process in Colombia.

MDP - Mesa de Diálogos de Paz (peace talks).

MVMV - *Mecanismo de Veeduría, Monitoreo y Verificación* (Oversight, Monitoring, and Verification Mechanism).

NNA - *Niños, niñas y adolescentes* (Children and adolescents).

OCCP - *Oficina del Consejero Comisionado de Paz* (Office of the Peace Commission Adviser).

OAS - Organization of American States.

PAN 1325 - *Plan de Acción Nacional de la Resolución 1325 del 2000 del Consejo de Seguridad de las Naciones Unidas* (National Action Plan of United Nations Security Council Resolution 1325 of 2000).

PATR - *Planes de Acción para la Transformación Regional* (Action Plans for Regional Transformation).

PCN - *Proceso de Comunidades Negras* (Black Communities Process).

PDET – *Programas de Desarrollo con Enfoque Territorial* (Territorially Focused Development Programs).

RRI - *Reforma Rural Integral* (Comprehensive Rural Reform).

SM - *Segunda Marquetalia*.

SNB - *Sistema Nacional de Búsqueda* (National Search System).

SRC - *Sujetos de Reparación Colectiva* (Subjects of Collective Reparation).

TECAM - *Territorios Campesinos Agroalimentarios* (Campesino Agri-Food Territories).

UARIV - *Unidad para la Atención y la Reparación Integral a Víctimas* (Unit for the Care and Comprehensive Reparation of Victims).

UBPD - *Unidad de Búsqueda de Personas dadas por Desaparecidas* (Unit for the Search for Missing Persons).

UNP - *Unidad Nacional de Protección* (National Protection Unit).

URT - *Unidad de Restitución de Tierras* (Land Restitution Unit).

ZRC - *Zonas de Reserva Campesina* (Campesino Reserve Zones).

ZRF - *Zonas de Reserva Forestal* (Forest Reserve Zones).